Survey Forms (Google Forms Clone)

Build Guide: Project Creation, File Map, Integration and Requirements

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1 Overview

This guide explains, in order, how to create the project, which files are created or changed at each step, and how the layers connect. The application lets a user build a survey, share a public link, collect validated responses, and view the submissions.

Stack. Next.js (App Router), Tailwind CSS v4, react-hook-form, Zod, `@better-fetch/fetch`, Hono (inside a Next.js route handler), Prisma 7 with PostgreSQL as the primary database, and Cloud Firestore (through the Firebase Admin SDK) as a live mirror of that data and as the store for uploaded files.

Project layout. The project uses the root `app/` layout (no `src/` folder). Section 5 says exactly what was checked and what was not.

Core idea. The API Zod schemas, kept one file per concern in `lib/schemas/`, are imported by both the browser and the API. The same rules therefore run in the form, in the Hono validator, and before anything reaches a database.

Decisions in this version.

- **Hono, not Elysia.** Hono runs inside a Next.js route handler, giving one project and one deployment.
- **Postgres is the source of truth; Firestore mirrors it.** Every write goes to Postgres through Prisma first and is then copied to Firestore under the same ids. If Postgres is unreachable, reads fall back to Firestore. Section 3 explains the design and its limits.
- **Files live in Firestore, not in a storage bucket.** A new Firebase bucket may need a paid plan, so uploaded files are stored as documents in a Firestore collection. This caps a file at 700 KB (Firestore documents are limited to 1 MiB). Moving to a real bucket later changes only `lib/server/repo/files.ts` and the two file routes.

2 Requirements

2.1 Software

Requirement	Version	Purpose
Node.js	22 or newer (24.18 used here)	Runtime
npm	10 or newer (11.16 used here)	Package manager
PostgreSQL	Local, Docker, Neon or Supabase	Primary database used by Prisma
Firebase project	Cloud Firestore enabled, Admin SDK service account	Mirror database and file store
Git	Any recent version	Version control

2.2 Packages

These are the versions installed in this project on 13 October 2026, read from `node_modules`.

Package	Version	Role
`next`	16.4.0	Framework (Turbopack, Cache Components on by default)
`react`, `react-dom`	19.3.0	UI
`tailwindcss`, `@tailwindcss/postcss`	4.3.3	Styling (v4, CSS-first)
`postcss`	8.5.30	Used by the Tailwind plugin
`zod`	4.6.7	Shared schemas and types
`react-hook-form`	7.90.0	Form state
`@hookform/resolvers`	5.9.1	Connects Zod to react-hook-form
`@better-fetch/fetch`	1.3.2	Typed HTTP client
`hono`	4.13.13	API framework
`@hono/zod-validator`	0.9.1	Request validation middleware
`@prisma/client`, `prisma`	7.10.0	Database client, migrations and generation
`@prisma/adapter-pg`, `pg`	7.10.0, 8.23.1	Postgres driver adapter (required by Prisma 7)
`firebase-admin`	14.5.0	Firestore access from the server
`dotenv`	18.0.7	Loads `.env` for `prisma.config.ts`
`typescript`, `eslint`, `prettier`	5.9.3, 9.39.5, 3.9.10	Types, lint, formatting

2.3 Why these libraries

Each package is here for one job, and the list is kept short on purpose.

Package	Why it is used
`next`, `react`, `react-dom`	One framework for pages, routing and server rendering, and the host for the API route handler.
`tailwindcss`, `@tailwindcss/postcss`, `postcss`	Utility-first styling without a separate stylesheet system. v4 is CSS-first, and the PostCSS plugin keeps styling independent of the bundler.
`zod`	One schema per concern, shared by the browser and the API, so the form, the validator and the database layer apply the same rules and the TypeScript types are inferred from them.
`react-hook-form`	Fast form state for the survey builder and response forms, with few re-renders.
`@hookform/resolvers`	Lets react-hook-form use the Zod schemas directly instead of duplicating rules.
`@better-fetch/fetch`	A TypeScript-first wrapper over native `fetch`: typed responses and one error shape, without the weight of Axios.
`hono`	A small, fast web framework that runs inside a Next.js route handler, so the API ships in the same project and deployment.
`@hono/zod-validator`	Validates request bodies, params and queries in Hono with the shared Zod schemas.
`@prisma/client`, `prisma`	A type-safe database client generated from the schema, plus migrations.
`@prisma/adapter-pg`, `pg`	Prisma 7 requires a driver adapter; this is the node-postgres one for PostgreSQL.
`firebase-admin`	Server-side access to Firestore, used as the live mirror and file store.
`dotenv`	Loads `.env` for `prisma.config.ts`, which Next.js does not do.
`typescript`, `eslint`, `prettier`	Static types, lint rules and consistent formatting.

Prisma versions must match. The npm `latest` tag of `prisma` pointed to an 8.0 release candidate while `@prisma/client` was 7.10.0. The install commands in Step 2 pin the three Prisma packages to 7.10.0. Change all three together when you upgrade.

2.4 Accounts and configuration

- A PostgreSQL connection string (`DATABASE_URL`).
- A Firebase project with a Cloud Firestore database (the `(default)` database; the free Spark plan is enough).
- A service account key for the Firebase Admin SDK: project id, client email and private key (Firebase console, Project settings, Service accounts, Generate new private key).
- A random token for the sync endpoints (`SYNC_TOKEN`).

3 How the Layers Connect

Layer	What it does
`components/`	Forms, tables and inputs. Validate with the shared Zod schemas before sending.
`lib/fetch.ts`	Typed client; every endpoint has input, output, params and query schemas.
`lib/server/routes/`	Hono routes. Validate again on the server; return one error shape.
`lib/server/repo/forms.ts`, `submissions.ts`	The only entry points the routes use. They combine the two databases.
`lib/server/repo/postgres/`	Prisma code: the source of truth.
`lib/server/repo/firestore/`	Firestore code: the mirror and the read fallback.
`lib/server/repo/files.ts`	Uploaded files, stored in Firestore.
`lib/server/repo/sync.ts`	Compares and repairs the two databases.

Writes. `createForm`, `deleteForm` and `createSubmission` run in Postgres first. Only after Postgres has committed does the same row go to Firestore, under the same id. A failure of the Firestore write is logged and does not fail the request, because the response is already correct; the sync endpoint repairs the difference.

Reads. Reads come from Postgres. If Postgres throws (for example it is unreachable), the same read runs against Firestore. A "not found" from Postgres is a real answer and is not retried.

Firestore layout. A form is one document in `forms/{id}` with its questions embedded and a `responseCount`. Each submission is a document in the subcollection `forms/{id}/submissions/{id}`. Uploaded files are documents in `files/{id}`.

Counter. When a submission is mirrored, a transaction writes the document and increments `responseCount` only if the document did not exist, so mirroring the same submission twice counts once.

Limits of this design.

- Sync is one-way, from Postgres to Firestore. Edits made directly in Firestore are overwritten by the next sync.
- When Postgres is down, reads work but new forms and submissions fail.
- Syncing is manual (an endpoint you call); there is no scheduler.

4 Step-by-Step Build

Step 1: Create the Next.js project with Tailwind v4

```
npx create-next-app@latest survey-forms --ts --tailwind --eslint --app --no-src-dir --use-npm --
    import-alias "@/*"
cd survey-forms
```

Files created by the generator: `package.json`, `tsconfig.json`, `next.config.ts`, `eslint.config.mjs`, `AGENTS.md`, `README.md`, and the folders `app/` and `public/`.

No `src/` folder. Every folder in this guide (`app/`, `components/`, `lib/` (with `lib/server/` and `lib/schemas/` inside), `prisma/`, `generated/`) sits at the project root. The `@/` alias points to the root through `"paths": { "@/*": ["./*"] }` in `tsconfig.json`, which the starter writes for you.

Tailwind v4. `app/globals.css` begins with `@import "tailwindcss";`. There are no `@tailwind` directives and no `tailwind.config.js`. Create `postcss.config.mjs` (listing in Section 12) so the styling does not depend on the starter's Turbopack rule.

Cache Components. The starter sets `cacheComponents: true`. Two rules follow, and the code already applies both. A route handler must not export `runtime`. Any page that awaits `params`, and any client component that creates random ids (react-hook-form's field array does), must sit inside a `Suspense` boundary, or `next build` fails.

Step 2: Install dependencies

Run each command on one line.

```
npm i zod react-hook-form @hookform/resolvers @better-fetch/fetch hono @hono/zod-validator
    firebase-admin pg dotenv @prisma/client@7.10.0 @prisma/adapter-pg@7.10.0
npm i -D prisma@7.10.0 @types/pg prettier
npm i tailwindcss @tailwindcss/postcss postcss
```

Step 3: Configure environment variables, Firestore and Git

Files created: `.env` (never committed) and `.env.example` (committed). Next.js loads `.env`; the Prisma CLI loads it through `dotenv`. Generate the token with `openssl rand -hex 24`.

Firebase values. Copy `project_id`, `client_email` and `private_key` from the downloaded service account JSON into `FIREBASE_PROJECT_ID`, `FIREBASE_CLIENT_EMAIL` and `FIREBASE_PRIVATE_KEY`. Keep the private key in double quotes on one line with the line breaks written as `\n`; `lib/server/firestore.ts` turns them back into real line breaks. Then delete the JSON file or keep it outside the project: it grants full admin access.

Create the database. In the Firebase console open Firestore and click Create database, accept the `(default)` database and choose a region. Security rules do not matter for this app, because the Admin SDK bypasses them and no browser talks to Firestore.

File updated: `.gitignore`. The starter already ignores `.env*`, which also hides the example file. Add:

```
!.env.example
/generated/prisma
*-firebase-adminsdk-*.json
serviceAccount*.json
```

Step 4: Define the database with Prisma

Files created: `prisma.config.ts` and `prisma/schema.prisma`. Prisma 7 reads the database URL from `prisma.config.ts`, writes the client to `generated/prisma`, and needs the `pg` driver adapter at runtime.

Model	What it represents	Why it is a separate model
`Form`	One survey (title, description)	Parent record; owns questions and submissions
`Question`	One prompt in a form	Needs its own type, options, order and required flag, and answers point to it
`Submission`	One respondent's attempt	Groups answers so each response can be counted, paged and deleted as a unit
`Answer`	One value for one question	Joins a submission to a question

```
npx prisma migrate dev --name init
npx prisma generate
```

Application code imports the client as `@/generated/prisma/client`. Do not drop or reset the database schema on a machine that holds real forms; a reset deletes them, and the Firestore mirror is only repopulated from Postgres, not the other way round.

Step 5: Server foundations

- `lib/server/env.ts`: validates the environment with Zod. Two lazy getters keep the database variables apart from the Firebase ones, so forms keep working when Firebase is not configured.
- `lib/server/db.ts`: one shared Prisma client with the Postgres adapter, kept on `globalThis` so hot reloading does not open new pools.
- `lib/server/firestore.ts`: starts the Firebase Admin app once (reused if it exists) and returns the Firestore database.
- `lib/server/errors.ts`: one error body shape, `{ error: { code, message } }`.
- `lib/server/methods.ts`: `methodNotAllowed`, the 405 and `Allow` helper used by every route file.
- `lib/server/validate.ts`: a wrapper around `zValidator` that returns the same 400 body with the list of issues.

Step 6: Write the schemas, one file per concern

- `lib/schemas/question.ts`: question types, the question schema and `isChoiceType`.
- `lib/schemas/form.ts`: create-form payload, form response, dashboard summary and the id parameter.
- `lib/schemas/upload.ts`: allowed file types, the 700 KB limit, the pattern a file id must match, and the upload result.
- `lib/schemas/submission.ts`: the answers payload, the page of submissions and `buildAnswerSchema`.
- `lib/schemas/builder.ts`: client-only, the one file in `lib/schemas/` the server never imports.

`z.email()` and `z.iso.date()` are Zod 4 forms; with an older Zod use `z.string().email()` and `z.string().date()`.

Step 7: Build the repository layer

- `lib/server/repo/postgres/forms.ts` and `submissions.ts`: all Prisma calls. Forms are parsed with `formSchema` so bad rows are caught on the server. `createSubmission` writes the submission and its answers in one nested create (a single transaction), skips empty answers, stores numbers as numbers, and returns what it stored so the same row can be mirrored.
- `lib/server/repo/firestore/forms.ts` and `submissions.ts`: mirror writes, mirror reads and the counter transaction described in Section 3.
- `lib/server/repo/dual.ts`: `mirrorSafely` (log, do not fail) and `readWithFallback`.
- `lib/server/repo/forms.ts` and `submissions.ts`: the facade the routes import. Postgres first, then mirror; Postgres read first, then fallback.
- `lib/server/repo/files.ts`: save, load and existence-check for uploaded files.
- `lib/server/repo/sync.ts`: `getSyncStatus` and `syncAll`.

Step 8: Build the Hono API

Method	Path	Input	Result
GET	`/api/forms`	none	200, forms with counts
POST	`/api/forms`	create-form payload	201, the form; 400
GET	`/api/forms/:id`	none	200; 404
DELETE	`/api/forms/:id`	none	204; 404
POST	`/api/forms/:id/submissions`	answers, checked against that form's questions	201, `{ id }`; 400; 404
GET	`/api/forms/:id/submissions`	`?page&limit`	200, one page; file answers are download paths
POST	`/api/files`	multipart field `file`	201, `{ id }`; 400
GET	`/api/files/:id`	none	200, the file as a download; 404
GET	`/api/sync/status`	bearer token	200, comparison of both databases; 401
POST	`/api/sync`	bearer token	200, what was copied; 401

405 for every other method. Build this once, then reuse it on every path.

1. Add a small helper in `lib/server/methods.ts`, `methodNotAllowed(app, path, allowedMethods)`. It builds the `Allow` value from the allowed methods plus `OPTIONS`, registers an `OPTIONS` handler that answers 204 with that header, and registers `app.all(path, ...)` that answers 405 with the `Allow` header and the usual error body, code `method_not_allowed`.
2. Call it at the end of each route file, after the real handlers, because Hono runs handlers in the order they were registered. Pass the methods that path really supports, for example `["GET", "POST"]` for `/api/forms`. `HEAD` is answered through `GET` automatically.

3. In `lib/server/app.ts` add `app.notFound(...)` for a JSON 404 and `app.onError(...)` for a generic 500 that logs the real error and never sends it to the client.
4. Check it: `curl -i -X DELETE /api/forms` should return 405 with `Allow: GET, POST, OPTIONS`, and an unknown path should return the JSON 404.

Error bodies look like `{ error: { code, message, issues? } }`.

Submissions. The route builds the answer schema from the form's own questions on every request, validates the body with it, checks that every file answer is the id of a file this app stored, and only then saves. A body that is not JSON becomes `null` and fails validation with a 400.

Files. The upload route re-checks type and size on the server, because the browser check can be skipped. Downloads are sent as attachments with `X-Content-Type-Options: nosniff`, so an uploaded file is never run as a page on this site.

Sync routes. They can rewrite a whole database and reveal counts, so they answer 401 unless the request carries `Authorization: Bearer <SYNC_TOKEN>`. With no token configured they stay closed.

Step 9: Mount Hono inside Next.js

`app/api/[[...route]]/route.ts` exports GET, POST, PUT, PATCH, DELETE and OPTIONS, all handled by the Hono app. All methods are exported on purpose: Next.js answers an unexported method with its own empty 405, while Hono answers with the JSON 405 and the `Allow` header. There is no `runtime` export, because Cache Components rejects it.

Step 10: Create the typed HTTP client and class patterns

`lib/fetch.ts` lists every JSON endpoint with its schemas, so a mistyped URL or wrong body is a type error and every response is validated. `getErrorMessage` reads the server's error message. File upload uses a plain `fetch` with `FormData` because a multipart body cannot be described by a Zod input schema; its response is still parsed with a schema. `lib/useLoad.ts` runs an async loader and reports loading, error or data. `lib/responsive/pattrens/forms.ts` holds every Tailwind class string, one object per component; components import their object as `p` and write `className={p.input}`. The folder keeps the spelling `pattrens` used in your other projects.

Step 11: Build the frontend

File	Responsibility
`app/page.tsx`	Dashboard: "New form" button and the list of forms.
`app/forms/new/page.tsx`	Builder page; the builder sits inside `Suspense`.
`app/f/[formId]/page.tsx`	Public survey page; params are read inside `Suspense`.
`app/forms/[id]/responses/page.tsx`	Responses page; params are read inside `Suspense`.
`app/layout.tsx`	Root layout. `<body>` has `suppressHydrationWarning` because browser extensions such as Grammarly add attributes before React loads.
`components/FormBuilder.tsx`	Create a form: react-hook-form with a field array and `builderFormSchema`.
`components/OptionsEditor.tsx`	Choices of one question: one input per option, add and remove, and a Yes / No preset.
`components/QuestionField.tsx`	One input per question type.
`components/FileUploadField.tsx`	Checks the file, uploads it to `/api/files`, stores the returned id.
`components/SurveyForm.tsx`	Fills in a survey with a schema built from its questions, then submits.
`components/SurveyLoader.tsx`	Loads a form for the public page.
`components/FormList.tsx`	Dashboard list with links to the survey and its responses.
`components/ResponsesView.tsx`	Table with one column per question and paging; file answers are links.

Step 12: Verify

```
npx prettier --check .
npx tsc --noEmit
npx eslint .
npm run build
npm run dev
```

Add a `.prettierignore` listing `.next`, `.agents`, `.claude`, `generated`, `node_modules` and `package-lock.json` so Prettier skips generated files. Do not run `npm run build` while `npm run dev` is serving the same folder: the build replaces the `.next` directory and can stop the dev server.

Then test by hand: create a form with one question of each type, open its public link, submit an invalid answer (an error appears next to that question), submit a valid one, and open the responses page.

Step 13: Operate the two databases

```
curl -H "Authorization: Bearer $SYNC_TOKEN" localhost:3000/api/sync/status
curl -X POST -H "Authorization: Bearer $SYNC_TOKEN" localhost:3000/api/sync
```

`status` lists form ids missing from Firestore, ids that exist only in Firestore, and both submission counts; `inSync` is true only when all of these match. Comparing ids matters: counts alone say "in sync" when one form was deleted and another added. `POST /api/sync` copies every form and

submission from Postgres (documents are replaced, so repeating it is safe), sets each form's counter to the real number, and removes Firestore forms that no longer exist in Postgres. Run it after any Firestore outage, after restoring Postgres from a backup, or when the server log shows "Firestore mirror failed".

5 What Was Verified

Checked in this project:

- `prettier -check`, `tsc -noEmit`, `eslint .` and `npm run build` all pass.
- API, against a running dev server with a real Postgres (Docker) and a real Firestore database: creating forms; rejecting a choice question with one option; rejecting invalid answers with one message per field; saving a valid submission and listing it with numbers stored as numbers; dashboard counts; 404 and 405 bodies.
- Files: upload of a text file, download as an attachment with `nosniff`, rejection of a disallowed type and of an 800 KB file, rejection of a malformed and of an unknown file id on submit, acceptance of a real id.
- Sync: new writes appear in both databases with equal counts; a form deleted from Firestore and a stray form added were both reported and repaired; deleting a form removes it from both; with the Postgres container stopped, the form list, a form and its submissions were still served from Firestore, and the databases matched again after Postgres returned.
- Browser: the builder creates a multi-choice form using the Yes / No preset; the public survey page renders the question and options; the hydration warning caused by a browser extension no longer shows.

Not checked:

- A full click-through of every question type in the browser (date and number inputs, the file input and the validation messages shown next to fields). They were checked through the API and the shared schemas only.
- The "Firestore mirror failed" path with a real Firestore error. Drift was created by editing Firestore by hand, not by a failing write.
- Deployment, concurrent writers, large data volumes, and a Firebase Storage bucket (not used).

6 Known Limits

- **No login.** Anyone with a form link can answer it, and the forms list, responses and file downloads need no sign-in. File ids are random and unguessable, but the responses endpoint returns them.
- **File size.** Files are limited to 700 KB because they are stored inside Firestore documents. Photos and short PDFs fit; larger files need a real bucket.
- **Orphaned files.** Deleting a form does not delete the files its answers pointed to.
- **One-way sync and manual repair**, as described in Section 3.
- **No Delete button.** Forms can only be deleted through the API.

7 Planned Extensions (Documentation Only)

This section describes how to close five gaps from the previous section. **None of it is implemented or tested.** It names the files to create or change, the rules to follow and the checks to run, so the work can be done step by step later. Names, paths and conventions are the same as in the rest of this guide.

Extension	Gap it closes	Main files
Delete button	Forms can only be deleted through the API	`components/DeleteFormButton.tsx`, `components/FormList.tsx`, `lib/fetch.ts`
Form editing	A form cannot be changed after it is created	`app/forms/[id]/edit/page.tsx`, `components/FormBuilder.tsx`, `lib/server/routes/forms.ts`
File limits	Files are capped at 700 KB and are left behind after a delete	`lib/server/repo/files.ts`, `lib/schemas/upload.ts`
Sync	Repair is manual and copies everything	`prisma/schema.prisma`, `lib/server/repo/outbox.ts`, `lib/server/routes/sync.ts`
Rate limiting	Any client can send unlimited requests	`lib/server/rateLimit.ts`, `lib/server/app.ts`

Read this first: login. The delete and edit API calls are open to anyone who can reach the server, with or without a button in the screen. A button makes them easier to use, not easier to abuse. Before the delete button and form editing go live, add a login and make the owner of a form the only person who can change or delete it. This needs a `userId` on `Form`, a check in every write route, and a session that the routes can read. It is a separate piece of work and is not described here.

7.1 Delete button

What already exists. `DELETE /api/forms/:id` returns 204, or 404 when the form is missing, and removes the form from Postgres (questions, submissions and answers cascade) and from Firestore. Only the screen is missing.

Files.

File	Action	Change
`components/DeleteFormButton.tsx`	create	Button with a two-step confirmation and its own loading and error state
`components/FormList.tsx`	update	Show the button on every row and remove the row after success
`lib/fetch.ts`	update	Add the `DELETE` endpoint with params and an output schema that accepts an empty body
`lib/responsive/pattrens/forms.ts`	update	Add a `deleteButtonPatterns` object for the button and the confirm row
`lib/server/repo/forms.ts`	update	Also delete the files the form's answers point to (see Section 7.3)

Rules.

1. **Confirm inside the page.** The first click turns the button into "Delete this form and its N responses? Yes / Cancel". Do not use `window.confirm`; it blocks the browser and cannot be styled with the patterns file. The response count is already in the list data.
2. **Disable while waiting.** The button is disabled and shows "Deleting..." until the request ends, so a double click sends one request.
3. **Treat 404 as success.** If another tab already deleted the form, remove the row and show nothing.
4. **Empty body.** A 204 has no body, so the client schema for this endpoint must accept an empty response. Without that, the client reports a validation error for a delete that worked.
5. **Update the list from the result.** Remove the row from the list state after a 204 or 404 instead of reloading the whole list. On any other error, keep the row and show the message from `getErrorMessage`.

Check. Delete a form that has a file answer. The row disappears, `GET /api/forms/:id` returns 404, `GET /api/files/:id` for its file returns 404, and the Firestore `forms/{id}` document and its `submissions` subcollection are gone.

7.2 Form editing

The hard part. Answers point to questions by id. If an edit replaced all questions with new rows, every old answer would lose its question. The design therefore keeps question ids stable and treats an edit as a set of per-question changes.

API. `PUT /api/forms/:id` with a new `updateFormSchema`: the same fields as `createFormSchema`, but each question may carry an `id`. The 405 list for `/:id` becomes `GET, PUT, DELETE`.

Rules for each question in the payload.

Case	What happens
Has an `id` that belongs to this form	Updated in place: label, required, options and position may change.
Has no `id`	Created as a new question.
Has an `id` from another form	Rejected with a 400. Check the id against the form's own questions.
Existing question missing from the payload	Deleted, and its answers cascade. If the form has responses, the screen must warn first, and the server must require `confirmRemoval: true` in the body, otherwise it answers 409.
Type changed on a question that has answers	Rejected with a 409. The type is locked once the question has an answer; to change it, delete the question and add a new one.
Option removed that existing answers use	Allowed, but the old answers keep their stored text. The responses table shows them as they were saved. State this in the screen.

Files.

File	Action	Change
`lib/schemas/form.ts`	update	`updateFormSchema` and its type; `id` is optional on each input question
`lib/server/repo/postgres/forms.ts`	update	`updateForm` inside one `prisma.$transaction`: update the form, update or create each question, delete the removed ones, and renumber `position`
`lib/server/repo/firestore/forms.ts`	reuse	`mirrorForm` already replaces the embedded question list; pass the stored response count so the counter is kept
`lib/server/repo/forms.ts`	update	`updateForm`: Postgres first, then `mirrorSafely`
`lib/server/routes/forms.ts`	update	`PUT /:id`, validated with the param and json validators; widen the 405 list
`lib/fetch.ts`	update	`PUT` endpoint with input and output schemas
`components/FormBuilder.tsx`	update	Accept an optional `initialForm`; in edit mode start from it, keep each question's `id` in the field array, and submit with `PUT`
`components/QuestionField.tsx`	none	Not used by the builder
`app/forms/[id]/edit/page.tsx`	create	Loads the form inside `Suspense`, then renders the builder in edit mode
`components/FormList.tsx`	update	"Edit" link next to "Responses"

Notes.

- **One transaction.** Do the whole update in one database transaction so a failure part-way leaves the old form intact.
- **Field array keys.** In react-hook-form, use `keyName` or a separate field for the `id`, because `useFieldArray` adds its own `id` to every item by default.
- **Old responses.** The responses table builds its columns from the current questions, so a deleted question's column disappears and its stored answers are no longer shown.
- **Concurrent edits.** Two editors saving at once will overwrite each other. A simple guard is an `updatedAt` value sent back with the edit; the server answers 409 when it no longer matches.

Check. Create a form, submit two responses, then edit: rename a question, add one, remove one, and try to change a type that has answers (expect 409). Open the responses page and confirm the old answers are still attached to the renamed question.

7.3 File limits

Why the limit is 700 KB. A file is stored as base64 text inside one Firestore document. Base64 adds about one third, and a document may not exceed 1 MiB, so 700 KB of file is about 950 KB of text plus the name and type. Raising the number in `lib/schemas/upload.ts` alone would make saves fail.

Options.

Option	How it works	Gain	Cost
Chunks in Firestore	Split the bytes into pieces of about 500 KB, each its own document under `files/{id}/chunks/{n}`	Several MB, no new service	More reads per download; the API still carries every byte
Cloud Storage bucket	Server signs a short-lived upload URL; the browser uploads straight to the bucket	Tens of MB; the API never handles file bytes	A bucket (the project may need a paid plan), bucket CORS, and a second kind of storage

Recommendation. Keep the three repository functions as they are (`saveFile`, `loadFile`, `fileExists`) so the routes do not change. Use chunks first if files up to a few MB are enough. Move to a bucket when larger files, video or many uploads are expected.

Steps for chunks.

1. In `lib/schemas/upload.ts`, set `MAX_FILE_BYTES` to the new limit (for example 5 MB) and add a `CHUNK_BYTES` constant of 500 KB.
2. In `lib/server/repo/files.ts`, write the metadata document `files/{id}` (name, type, size, chunk count) and the chunks in a batched write. Stay inside the 500-operation limit of one batch.
3. In `loadFile`, read the chunks in order and join them. Return the same shape as today.
4. In the route, check the size before reading the file into memory, and set the same limit on the client check.
5. Delete files together with their chunks (`recursiveDelete`).

Hosting limit. Many hosts limit the size of a request body that goes through a server function (for example about 4.5 MB on Vercel). Check your host before choosing a limit above that; this is the main reason to prefer a bucket with direct uploads.

Orphaned files. Today deleting a form leaves its files in Firestore. Fix it in the repository facade: before deleting the form, read the file ids from the answers of its file questions, delete the form, then delete those files with `mirrorSafely` so a failure is logged and not returned. Also add a cleanup in the sync step for files that no answer points to and that are older than a day (an upload that was never submitted).

Other limits worth adding. A total file size per form, a file count per submission (one file per file question already), and a content check that compares the file's first bytes with the declared type, because the browser's `file.type` can be wrong or faked.

Check. Upload files just under and just over the new limit (expect 201 and 400), download a multi-chunk file and compare its checksum with the original, and delete a form to confirm no chunk documents remain.

7.4 Sync

Gaps today. Repair is manual, `syncAll` copies every form and submission each time, and a failed mirror write is only a line in the log, with nothing remembering which row failed.

Design: an outbox. When a mirror write fails, the failure is stored in Postgres so it can be retried. This replaces "log and forget" in `mirrorSafely`.

```
// prisma/schema.prisma (design)
// Why: remembers a mirror write that failed, so it can be retried.
model MirrorTask {
  id        String   @id @default(cuid())
  entity    String   // "form", "submission" or "file"
  entityId  String
  formId    String?  // needed to find a submission's parent
  action    String   // "upsert" or "delete"
  attempts  Int      @default(0)
  lastError String?
  createdAt DateTime @default(now())
  @@index([createdAt])
}
```

File	Action	Change
`prisma/schema.prisma`	update	Add `MirrorTask`, then `npx prisma migrate dev -name mirror_task`
`lib/server/repo/outbox.ts`	create	`recordFailure`, `processTasks` (retry in age order, delete the task on success, count attempts and keep the error on failure)
`lib/server/repo/dual.ts`	update	On a mirror error call `recordFailure`; if that also fails, log it
`lib/server/repo/sync.ts`	update	Add `processTasks` before the full comparison, and report the number of waiting tasks in the status
`lib/server/routes/sync.ts`	update	`POST /api/sync/retry` runs only the outbox; `status` adds `pendingTasks`

Running it on a schedule. The app has no scheduler, so something outside it calls the endpoint with the bearer token. Choose one:

- the host's scheduled jobs, if it offers them (check whether they send a `GET` or a `POST`; the route accepts only the method it declares, so match it or add a second route);
- a scheduled GitHub Actions workflow that runs `curl -X POST -H "Authorization: Bearer $SYNC_TOKEN"` against `/api/sync/retry` every few minutes and `/api/sync` once a day;
- any external cron service.

Store the token as a secret of that service and never in the repository.

Make the full sync cheaper. Add `updatedAt` to `Form` (Prisma's `@updatedAt`) and let a daily sync copy only forms changed since the last run, keeping the full comparison for a weekly run. Submissions are never edited, so only new ones need copying.

Alerts. Call `GET /api/sync/status` on a schedule and notify someone when `inSync` is false or `pendingTasks` keeps growing.

Decision to keep. Sync stays one-way: Postgres wins. Two-way sync needs conflict rules and is out of scope.

Check. Stop Firestore access (use a wrong key), create a form (the request still succeeds), confirm a `MirrorTask` row exists, restore the key, call `/api/sync/retry`, and confirm the row is gone and the form appears in Firestore.

7.5 Rate limiting

Why. The survey page and its submit and upload routes are public. Without a limit, one client can fill a form with junk, upload files until storage grows, or make the server call the databases without end.

Where. One Hono middleware in `lib/server/rateLimit.ts`, registered in `lib/server/app.ts` before the route groups, so every path is counted, including paths that answer 405. The sync routes stay protected by their token and are not counted.

Proposed limits (per client, per minute; tune them with real traffic):

Route group	Limit	Reason
`POST /api/forms/:id/submissions`	10 per minute	A person answers a form a few times at most
`POST /api/files`	5 per minute	Uploads are the most expensive request
`POST /api/forms`, `PUT`, `DELETE`	20 per minute	Owner actions; stricter once there is a login
All other `GET` requests	120 per minute	Page loads and polling

Rules.

1. **Client key.** Use the IP address. Behind a proxy or host the real address is in `X-Forwarded-For`; read only the value your host sets, and ignore the header when the app is reachable directly, otherwise a client can invent its own address and avoid the limit.
2. **Answer.** When a client is over the limit, return 429 with the usual error body (code `rate_limited`), a `Retry-After` header in seconds, and the same headers on normal responses (`RateLimit-Limit`, `RateLimit-Remaining`) so a client can slow down early.
3. **Algorithm.** A sliding window is fairer than a fixed window, which lets a client send a full limit at the end of one minute and again at the start of the next.
4. **Fail open or closed.** If the limit store is unreachable, let the request through and log it for public reads, but refuse writes. A broken limiter should not take the survey page down.

Where to keep the counters.

Store	Works when	Problem
Memory of the process (a `Map`)	One server that stays running (local, one container)	Resets on restart, and every server function instance has its own counters, so the real limit is higher
Redis (for example Upstash with its rate-limit library)	Several instances or serverless; this is the normal choice	A new service and an environment variable for its address and token
Postgres table	No new service is wanted	A write on every request; fine for low traffic only

Start with the in-memory store behind a small interface (`hit(key, limit, windowSeconds)`) and swap the store when the app runs on more than one instance.

Related protections, outside the limiter.

- A bot check (for example a Turnstile or reCAPTCHA token) on the public submit route, verified on the server.
- A maximum JSON body size, so a very large body is refused before it is parsed.
- A hidden "honeypot" field in the survey form that real people leave empty; a filled value is rejected.

Check. Send 11 submissions in a minute with a shell loop; the first 10 return 201 and the 11th returns 429 with `Retry-After`. Wait for the window and confirm the next request succeeds. Confirm `GET /api/sync/status` with a valid token is never limited.

7.6 Suggested order

1. Login and form ownership (prerequisite for the delete button and editing).
2. Rate limiting (small, and protects everything below).
3. Delete button, including deleting a form's files.
4. Sync outbox and a scheduled call.
5. Form editing.
6. File limits (chunks or a bucket).

After each step run the checks from Step 12 (`prettier`, `tsc`, `eslint`, `npm run build`) and the `Check` paragraph of that extension.

8 Database Schema (Mermaid ER Diagram)

Figure 1 shows the four PostgreSQL models from Step 4 and how they relate. Deleting a form cascades to its questions and submissions, and deleting a submission or a question cascades to its answers.

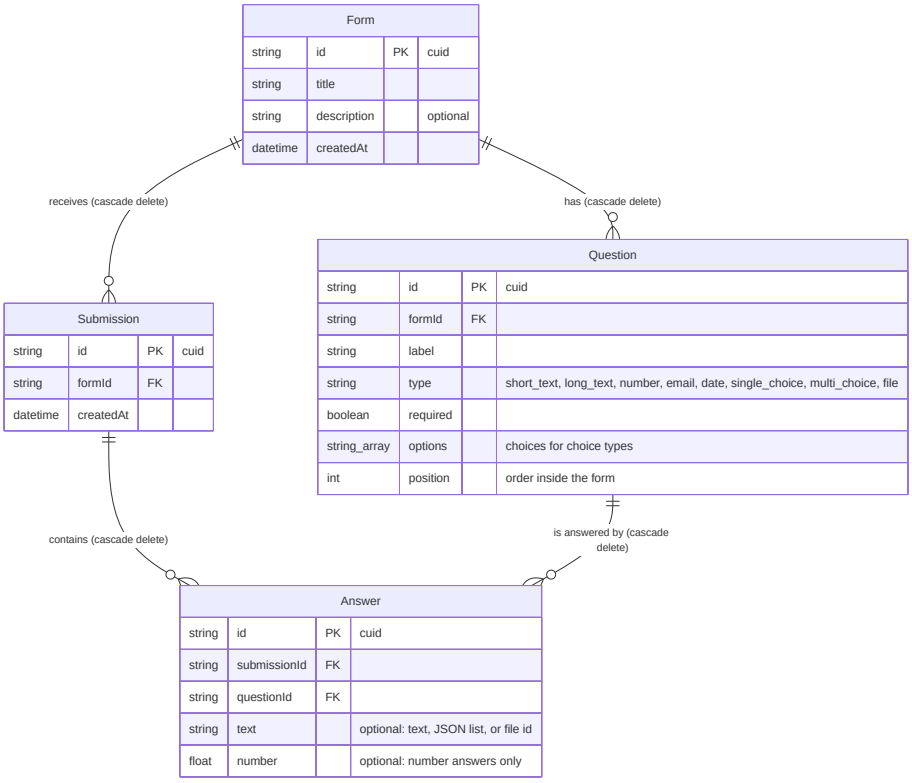


Figure 1: Entity-relationship diagram of the PostgreSQL database (source of truth).

- `Question.type` is stored as text and restricted by the Zod enum at the API boundary.
- `Question.options` is a text array, used only by the two choice types.
- `Answer` stores a number in `number` and everything else (text, a JSON list for multi-choice, or a file id) in `text`. Empty answers are not stored.
- `Question.position` keeps the order of the questions inside a form.

8.1 Firestore layout

Firestore is the mirror and the file store. Figure 2 shows its collections. Every document uses the same id as its Postgres row, which is what lets the sync endpoint compare and repair the two databases by id.

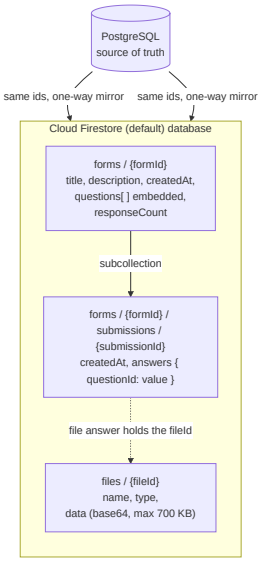


Figure 2: Firestore collections and how they relate to PostgreSQL.

9 System Architecture (Mermaid Flowchart)

Figure 3 shows the layers. The shared Zod schemas are imported by the form, the HTTP client and the API validator. Routes never touch a database directly: they call the repository layer, which writes to PostgreSQL first and mirrors to Firestore, and reads from PostgreSQL with Firestore as the fallback. Files bypass PostgreSQL and live only in Firestore.

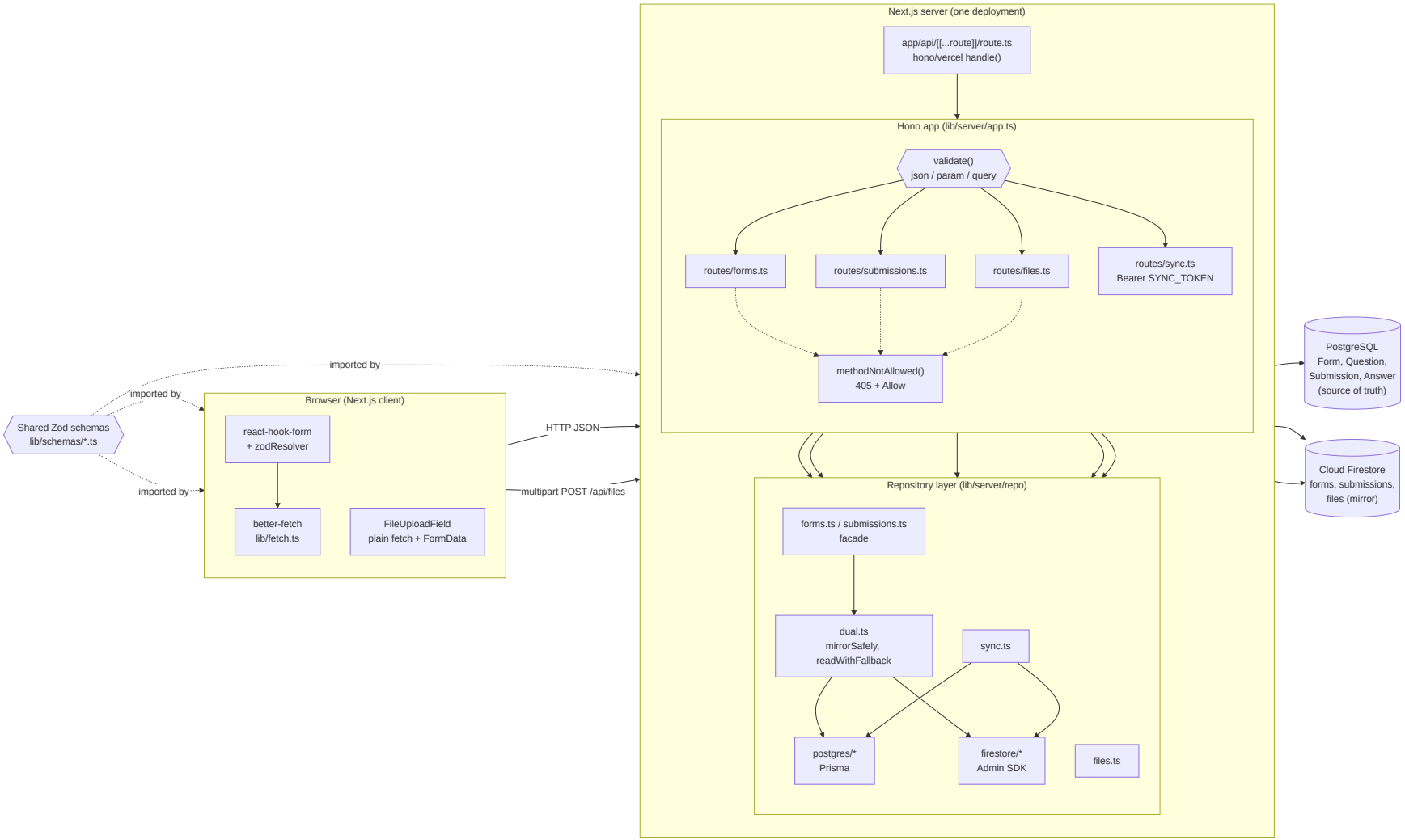


Figure 3: Architecture of the application as built.

9.1 Architecture with the planned extensions

Figure 4 shows the same system with the extensions from Section 7. Dashed amber boxes are planned and not built; solid boxes exist today. The rate-limit and auth middleware sit in front of validation, a failed mirror write goes to an outbox table that the sync routes retry, an external scheduler calls the token-protected sync routes, and the delete and edit screens reuse the same typed client.

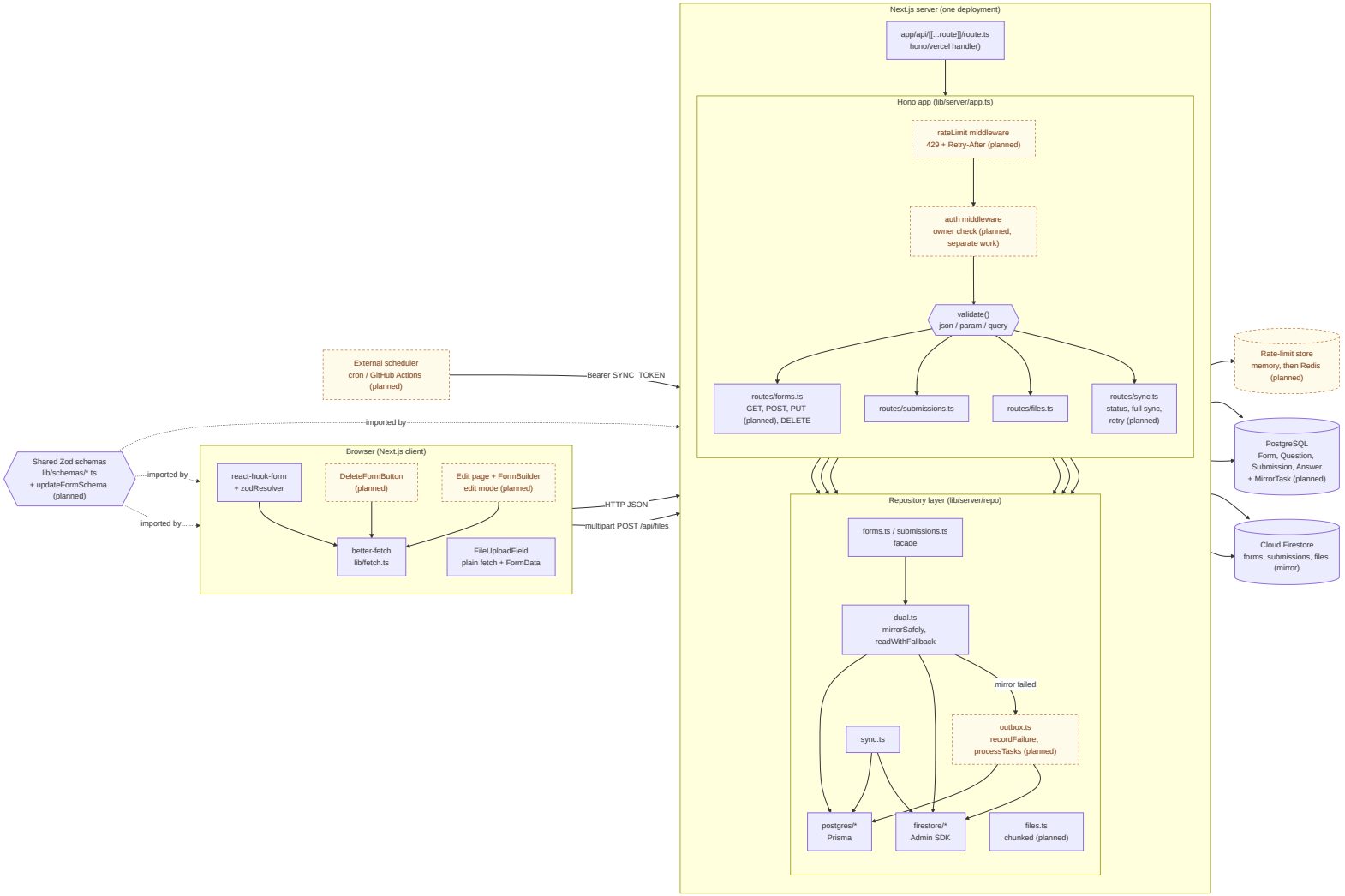


Figure 4: Architecture with the planned extensions (dashed = planned).

10 Request Flows (Mermaid Sequence Diagrams)

10.1 Submitting a response

Figure 5 follows one submission, including an optional file upload. The answers are validated twice with the same schema, in the browser and on the server, and the server also checks that every file answer is the id of a stored file.

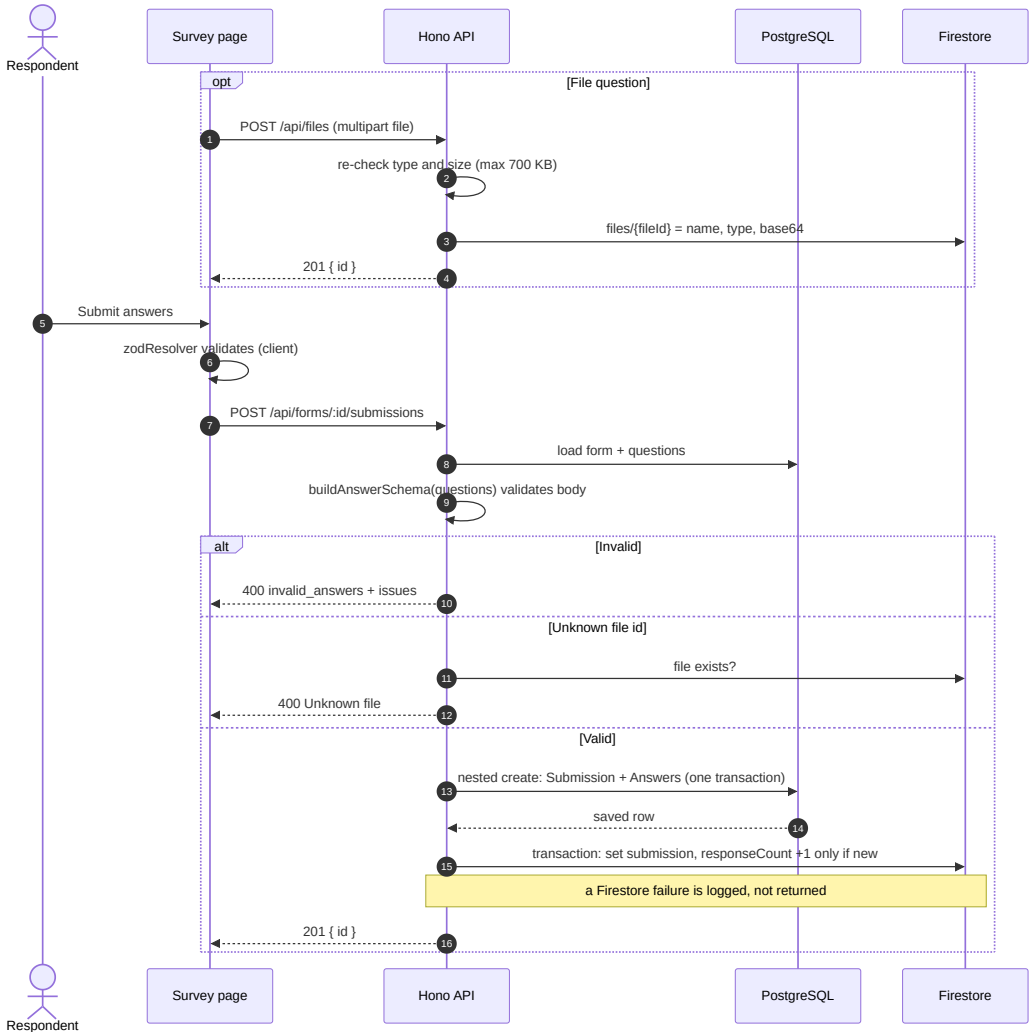


Figure 5: Submitting a response: upload, validation, Postgres write and Firestore mirror.

10.2 Reading with fallback, and repairing with sync

Figure 6 shows a read that falls back to Firestore when PostgreSQL throws, and the two token-protected sync calls an operator runs after an outage or a restore.

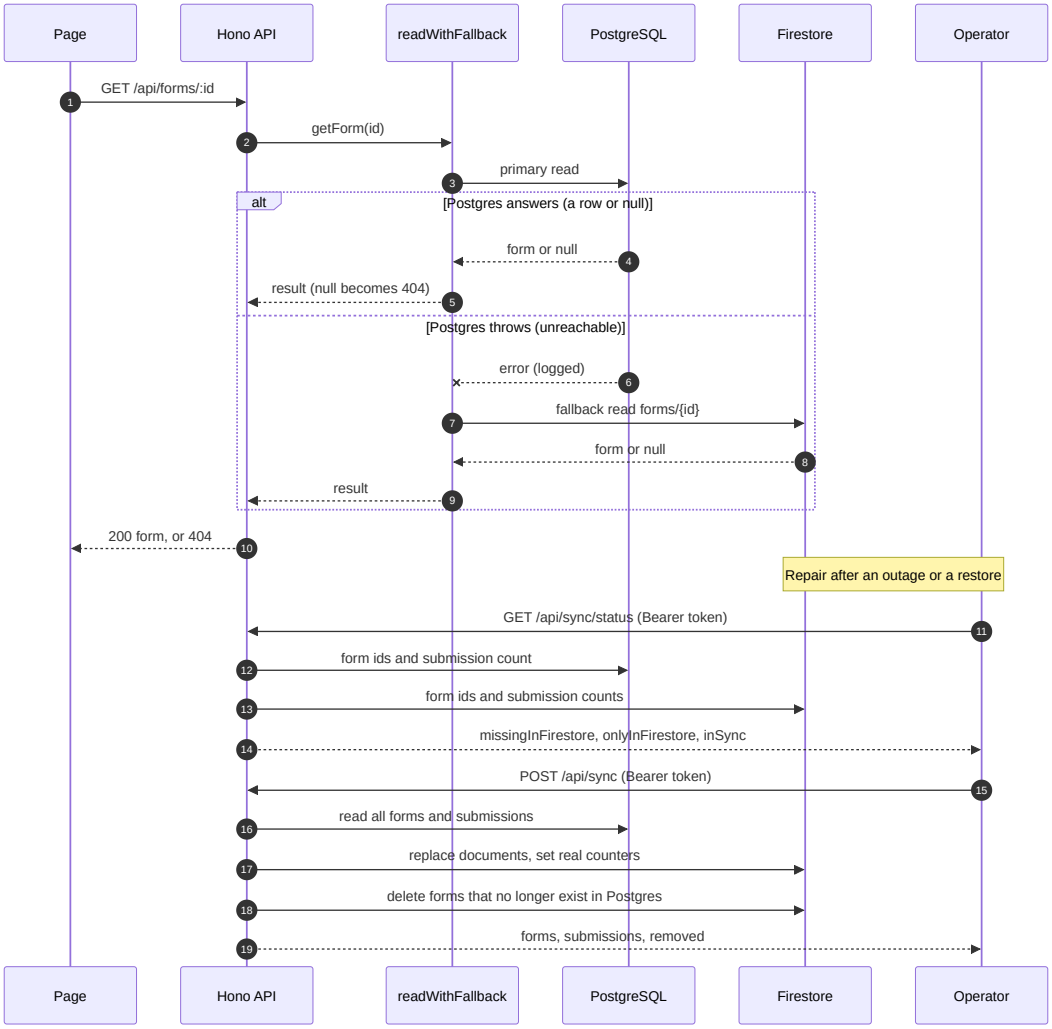


Figure 6: Read fallback and the sync endpoints.

11 Development Workflow (Mermaid Flowcharts)

11.1 How the project is built and checked

Figure 7 shows the order of work in Steps 1 to 13. The project is built layer by layer, from the schemas up to the pages, and the same four commands run after every layer so an error is found where it was made. A failing check sends the work back to the layer that caused it.

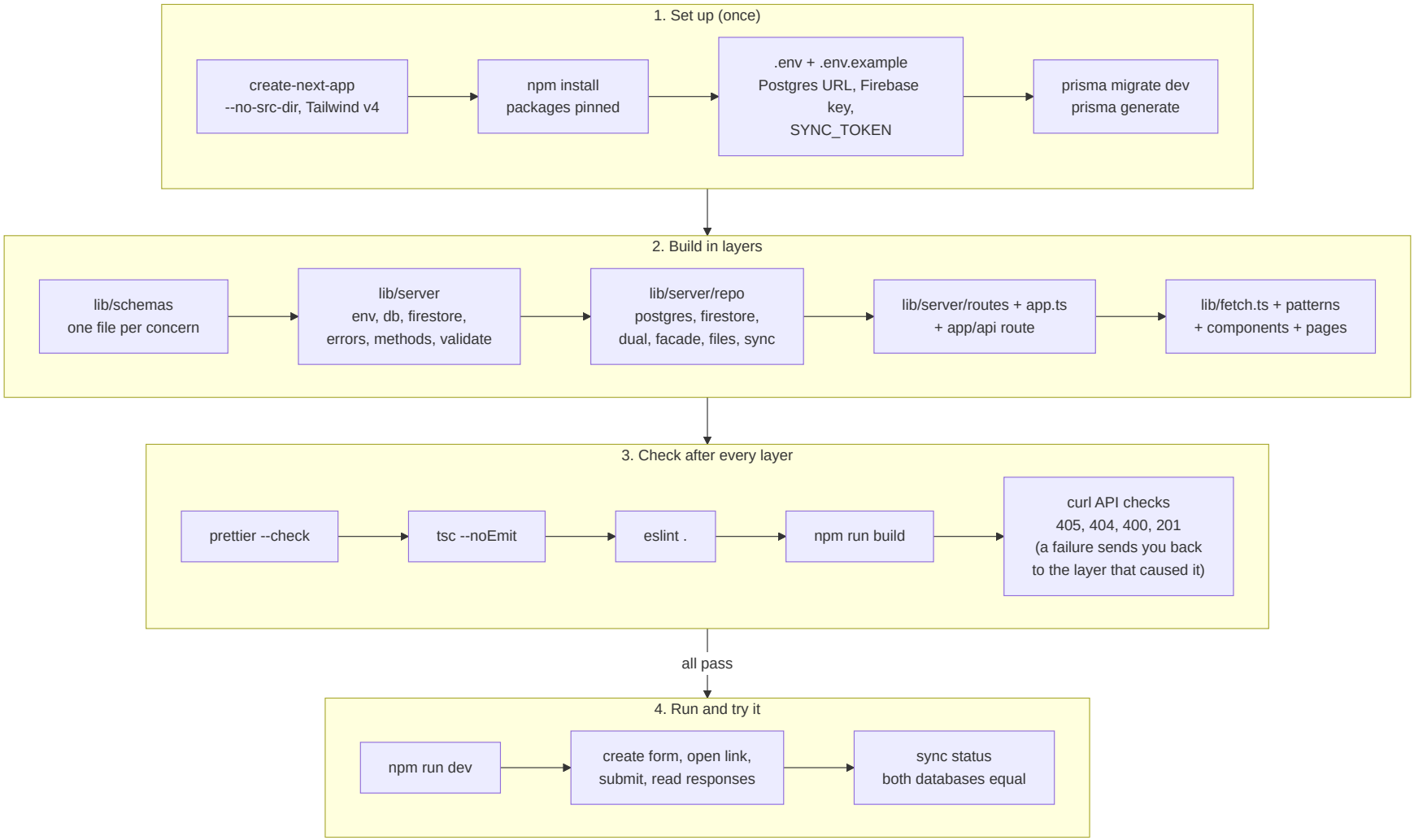


Figure 7: Development workflow: set up, build in layers, check, run.

11.2 Roadmap for the planned extensions

Figure 8 shows which extension depends on which, and matches the suggested order in Section 7. Login and rate limiting come first because the delete button and form editing should not ship while anyone can call those routes.

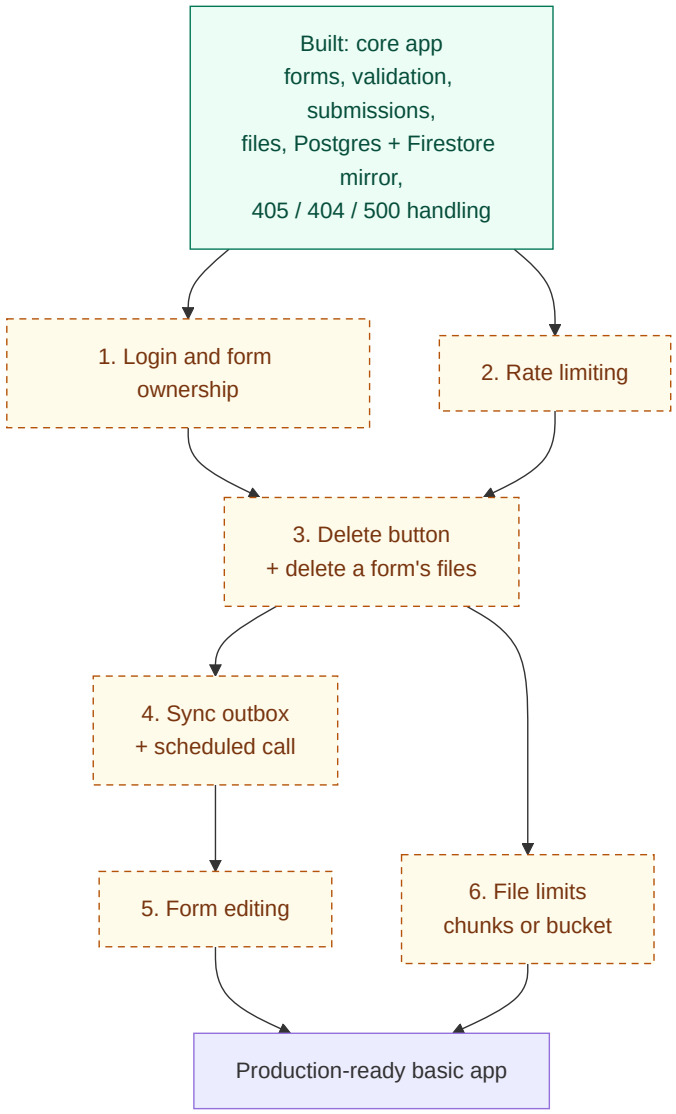


Figure 8: Roadmap: built core and the planned extensions (dashed = planned).

12 Source Code

Every listing below is the complete content of the file, so you can type it in step by step. The set was type-checked together (`tsc -noEmit`) and formatted with Prettier. The code follows these conventions: braces on every `if`, a doc comment on each function, descriptive names, Prettier width 80 with single quotes and trailing commas, and no inline Tailwind classes (they live in the patterns file). Comments marked "Why" explain a decision, not the syntax.

12.1 Configuration

File: `prisma.config.ts`. Prisma 7 configuration: schema path, migrations path and database URL.

```
import 'dotenv/config';
import { defineConfig } from 'prisma/config';

/** Prisma 7 reads the schema path, migrations path and database URL here. */
export default defineConfig({
  schema: 'prisma/schema.prisma',
  migrations: { path: 'prisma/migrations' },
  datasource: { url: process.env['DATABASE_URL'] },
});
```

File: `prisma/schema.prisma`. The four models, with a comment on why each exists.

```
generator client {
  provider = "prisma-client"
  output   = "../generated/prisma"
}

datasource db {
  provider = "postgresql"
}

// Why: the parent record. It owns the questions and the submissions.
model Form {
  id          String       @id @default(cuid())
  title       String
  description String?
  createdAt   DateTime     @default(now())
  questions   Question[]
  submissions Submission[]
}

// Why: a question needs its own type, options, order and required flag,
// and answers point to it.
model Question {
  id       String   @id @default(cuid())
  formId   String
  form     Form     @relation(fields: [formId], references: [id], onDelete: Cascade)
  label    String
  type     String
  required Boolean  @default(false)
  options  String[]
  position Int
  answers  Answer[]
}

// Why: groups answers so one response can be counted, paged and deleted
// as a unit.
model Submission {
```

```
  id        String   @id @default(cuid())
  formId    String
  form      Form     @relation(fields: [formId], references: [id], onDelete: Cascade)
  createdAt DateTime @default(now())
  answers   Answer[]
}

// Why: joins a submission to a question. A number is stored in `number`,
// everything else (including a file id) in `text`.
model Answer {
  id           String     @id @default(cuid())
  submissionId String
  submission   Submission @relation(fields: [submissionId], references: [id], onDelete: Cascade)
  questionId   String
  question     Question   @relation(fields: [questionId], references: [id], onDelete: Cascade)
  text         String?
  number       Float?
}
```

File: `postcss.config.mjs`. Tailwind v4 PostCSS plugin.

```
/** Tailwind v4 runs as a PostCSS plugin, independent of the bundler. */
const config = {
  plugins: {
    '@tailwindcss/postcss': {},
  },
};

export default config;
```

File: `.env.example`. Environment variable template.

```
# PostgreSQL connection string
DATABASE_URL=postgresql://user:pass@localhost:5432/surveys

# Firebase Admin SDK service account (Project settings, Service accounts)
FIREBASE_PROJECT_ID=
FIREBASE_CLIENT_EMAIL=
# One line, in double quotes, with line breaks written as \n
FIREBASE_PRIVATE_KEY=

# Bearer token for GET /api/sync/status and POST /api/sync
SYNC_TOKEN=
```

File: `.prettierrc`. Prettier settings: width 80, single quotes, trailing commas.

```
{
  "printWidth": 80,
  "singleQuote": true,
  "trailingComma": "all"
}
```

12.2 Shared API schemas

File: `lib/schemas/question.ts`. Question types, schema and helper.

```
import { z } from 'zod';

export const questionTypes = [
  'short_text',
  'long_text',
```

```
  'number',
  'email',
  'date',
  'single_choice',
  'multi_choice',
  'file',
] as const;

export const questionTypeSchema = z.enum(questionTypes);
export type QuestionType = z.infer<typeof questionTypeSchema>;

/** True for the types that need a list of options. */
export function isChoiceType(type: QuestionType): boolean {
  return type === 'single_choice' || type === 'multi_choice';
}

const questionBase = z.object({
  label: z.string().trim().min(1, 'Question text is required').max(200),
  type: questionTypeSchema,
  required: z.boolean(),
  options: z.array(z.string().trim().min(1).max(100)).max(20).default([]),
});

/** A choice question needs at least two options. */
function requireOptionsForChoice(
  question: { type: QuestionType; options: string[] },
  ctx: z.RefinementCtx,
): void {
  if (isChoiceType(question.type) && question.options.length < 2) {
    ctx.addIssue({
      code: 'custom',
      path: ['options'],
      message: 'A choice question needs at least two options',
    });
  }
}

/** A question as sent when creating a form. */
export const questionInputSchema = questionBase.superRefine(
  requireOptionsForChoice,
);

/** A question as stored and returned: it also has an id and a position. */
export const questionSchema = questionBase
  .extend({ id: z.string().min(1), position: z.number().int().min(0) })
  .superRefine(requireOptionsForChoice);

export type QuestionInput = z.infer<typeof questionInputSchema>;
export type Question = z.infer<typeof questionSchema>;
```

File: `lib/schemas/form.ts`. Create-form payload, form response, dashboard summary.

```
import { z } from 'zod';
import { questionInputSchema, questionSchema } from './question';

export const createFormSchema = z.object({
  title: z.string().trim().min(1, 'Title is required').max(200),
  description: z.string().trim().max(2000).optional(),
  questions: z
    .array(questionInputSchema)
    .min(1, 'Add at least one question')
    .max(50),
});
```

```
export const formSchema = z.object({
  id: z.string().min(1),
  title: z.string(),
  description: z.string().nullable(),
  createdAt: z.string(),
  questions: z.array(questionSchema),
});

/** One row of the dashboard list. */
export const formSummarySchema = z.object({
  id: z.string().min(1),
  title: z.string(),
  createdAt: z.string(),
  questionCount: z.number().int(),
  responseCount: z.number().int(),
});

export const formIdParamSchema = z.object({ id: z.string().min(1) });

export type CreateFormInput = z.infer<typeof createFormSchema>;
export type Form = z.infer<typeof formSchema>;
export type FormSummary = z.infer<typeof formSummarySchema>;
```

File: `lib/schemas/upload.ts`. Upload limits, allowed types, file id pattern.

```
import { z } from 'zod';

/** Files are stored inside Firestore documents, which are capped at 1 MiB. */
export const MAX_FILE_BYTES = 700 * 1024;

export const ALLOWED_FILE_TYPES = [
  'application/pdf',
  'image/png',
  'image/jpeg',
  'text/plain',
] as const;

/** A file id is 32 lowercase hex characters (a UUID without dashes). */
export const FILE_ID_PATTERN = /^[a-f0-9]{32}$/;

export const fileIdSchema = z
  .string()
  .regex(FILE_ID_PATTERN, 'Invalid file id');
export const fileIdParamSchema = z.object({ id: fileIdSchema });
export const uploadResultSchema = z.object({ id: fileIdSchema });

export type UploadResult = z.infer<typeof uploadResultSchema>;
```

File: `lib/schemas/submission.ts`. Answers, submissions page, and the runtime answer schema.

```
import { z } from 'zod';
import { fileIdSchema } from './upload';
import { isChoiceType, type Question } from './question';

/** One answer is text, or a list of texts for a multi-choice question. */
const answerValueSchema = z.union([z.string(), z.array(z.string())]);

export const answersPayloadSchema = z.object({
  answers: z.record(z.string(), answerValueSchema),
});

export const submissionSchema = z.object({
  id: z.string().min(1),
  createdAt: z.string(),
```

```
  answers: z.record(z.string(), answerValueSchema),
});

export const pageQuerySchema = z.object({
  page: z.coerce.number().int().min(1).default(1),
  limit: z.coerce.number().int().min(1).max(100).default(20),
});

export const submissionsPageSchema = z.object({
  items: z.array(submissionSchema),
  page: z.number().int(),
  limit: z.number().int(),
  total: z.number().int(),
});

export const submissionIdSchema = z.object({ id: z.string().min(1) });

export type Submission = z.infer<typeof submissionSchema>;
export type SubmissionsPage = z.infer<typeof submissionsPageSchema>;

/** Builds the rule for one question's answer. */
function answerSchemaFor(question: Question): z.ZodType<unknown> {
  let schema: z.ZodType<unknown>;
  switch (question.type) {
    case 'number':
      schema = z.string().refine((v) => v === '' || !Number.isNaN(Number(v)), {
        message: 'Enter a number',
      });
      break;
    case 'email':
      schema = z.union([z.literal(''), z.email('Enter a valid email')]);
      break;
    case 'date':
      schema = z.union([z.literal(''), z.iso.date('Enter a valid date')]);
      break;
    case 'file':
      schema = z.union([z.literal(''), fileIdSchema]);
      break;
    case 'single_choice':
      schema = z.union([
        z.literal(''),
        z.enum(question.options as [string, ...string[]]),
      ]);
      break;
    case 'multi_choice':
      schema = z.array(z.enum(question.options as [string, ...string[]]));
      break;
    default:
      schema = z.string().max(5000);
  }
  if (!question.required) {
    return schema;
  }
  return schema.refine(
    (v) => (Array.isArray(v) ? v.length > 0 : v !== '' && v !== undefined),
    { message: 'This question is required' },
  );
}

/**
 * Builds the answer schema from a form's own questions, so the browser form
 * and the API apply exactly the same rules. Answers are keyed by question id.
 */
export function buildAnswerSchema(questions: Question[]) {
  const shape: Record<string, z.ZodType<unknown>> = {};
```

```
  for (const question of questions) {
    const base = answerSchemaFor(question);
    shape[question.id] = question.required
      ? base
      : isChoiceType(question.type) && question.type === 'multi_choice'
        ? base.default([])
        : base.optional();
  }
  return z.object(shape);
}
```

12.3 Server foundations

File: `lib/server/env.ts`. Lazy, validated environment variables.

```
import { z } from 'zod';

const databaseSchema = z.object({ DATABASE_URL: z.string().min(1) });

const firebaseSchema = z.object({
  FIREBASE_PROJECT_ID: z.string().min(1),
  FIREBASE_CLIENT_EMAIL: z.string().min(1),
  FIREBASE_PRIVATE_KEY: z.string().min(1),
});

/**
 * Why two lazy getters: each one validates only when called, so forms keep
 * working when Firebase is not configured.
 */
export function getDatabaseEnv() {
  return databaseSchema.parse(process.env);
}

export function getFirebaseEnv() {
  return firebaseSchema.parse(process.env);
}

/** The sync token, or undefined when none is set (sync stays closed). */
export function getSyncToken(): string | undefined {
  return process.env.SYNC_TOKEN || undefined;
}
```

File: `lib/server/db.ts`. Shared Prisma client with the Postgres adapter.

```
import { PrismaPg } from '@prisma/adapter-pg';
import { PrismaClient } from '@/generated/prisma/client';
import { getDatabaseEnv } from './env';

const globalForPrisma = globalThis as unknown as { prisma?: PrismaClient };

/** Creates the Prisma client with the node-postgres adapter. */
function createClient(): PrismaClient {
  const adapter = new PrismaPg({
    connectionString: getDatabaseEnv().DATABASE_URL,
  });
  return new PrismaClient({ adapter });
}

/**
 * Why globalThis: hot reloading re-runs this module, and a new client each
 * time would open a new connection pool.
 */
```

```
export const prisma = globalForPrisma.prisma ?? createClient();

if (process.env.NODE_ENV !== 'production') {
  globalForPrisma.prisma = prisma;
}
```

File: `lib/server/firestore.ts`. Firebase Admin app and Firestore database.

```
import { cert, getApps, initializeApp } from 'firebase-admin/app';
import { getFirestore } from 'firebase-admin/firestore';
import { getFirebaseEnv } from './env';

/** Starts the Firebase Admin app once and returns the Firestore database. */
export function getDb() {
  const env = getFirebaseEnv();
  const app =
    getApps()[0] ??
    initializeApp({
      credential: cert({
        projectId: env.FIREBASE_PROJECT_ID,
        clientEmail: env.FIREBASE_CLIENT_EMAIL,
        // The key is stored on one line with \n; turn it back into line breaks.
        privateKey: env.FIREBASE_PRIVATE_KEY.replace(/\\n/g, '\n'),
      }),
    });
  return getFirestore(app);
}
```

File: `lib/server/errors.ts`. The one error body shape.

```
import type { Context } from 'hono';
import type { ContentfulStatusCode } from 'hono/utils/http-status';

export type ApiErrorBody = {
  error: { code: string; message: string; issues?: unknown };
};

/** The one error body shape used by every endpoint. */
export function errorBody(
  code: string,
  message: string,
  issues?: unknown,
): ApiErrorBody {
  return {
    error: { code, message, ...(issues === undefined ? {} : { issues }) },
  };
}

/** Sends the error body with a status and optional headers. */
export function jsonError(
  c: Context,
  status: ContentfulStatusCode,
  code: string,
  message: string,
  headers?: Record<string, string>,
) {
  return c.json(errorBody(code, message), status, headers);
}
```

File: `lib/server/methods.ts`. Helper that adds the 405 + Allow catch-all to a path.

```
import type { Hono } from 'hono';
import { jsonError } from './errors';
```

```
/**
 * Answers every method not handled on `path` with a JSON 405 and an `Allow`
 * header. Call it AFTER the real handlers for the path, because Hono runs
 * handlers in the order they were registered.
 */
export function methodNotAllowed(app: Hono, path: string, allowed: string[]) {
  const allow = [...new Set([...allowed, 'OPTIONS'])].join(', ');
  app.options(path, (c) => c.body(null, 204, { Allow: allow }));
  app.all(path, (c) =>
    jsonError(
      c,
      405,
      'method_not_allowed',
      `${c.req.method} is not allowed here. Allowed: ${allow}.`,
      { Allow: allow },
    ),
  );
}
```

File: `lib/server/validate.ts`. zValidator wrapper with a consistent 400 body.

```
import { zValidator } from '@hono/zod-validator';
import type { ZodType } from 'zod';
import { errorBody } from './errors';

type Target = 'json' | 'param' | 'query';

/** zValidator with the same 400 body everywhere, listing every issue. */
export function validate<T extends ZodType>(target: Target, schema: T) {
  return zValidator(target, schema, (result, c) => {
    if (!result.success) {
      const issues = result.error.issues.map((issue) => ({
        path: issue.path.join('.'),
        message: issue.message,
      }));
      return c.json(
        errorBody('invalid_request', 'Invalid request', issues),
        400,
      );
    }
  });
}
```

12.4 Repository layer

File: `lib/server/repo/postgres/forms.ts`. Form data access in Postgres (source of truth).

```
import { prisma } from '../../db';
import {
  formSchema,
  type CreateFormInput,
  type Form,
  type FormSummary,
} from '@/lib/schemas/form';

/** Lists every form with its question and response counts. */
export async function listForms(): Promise<FormSummary[]> {
  const rows = await prisma.form.findMany({
    orderBy: { createdAt: 'desc' },
    include: { _count: { select: { questions: true, submissions: true } } },
  });
```

```
  return rows.map((row) => ({
    id: row.id,
    title: row.title,
    createdAt: row.createdAt.toISOString(),
    questionCount: row._count.questions,
    responseCount: row._count.submissions,
  }));
}

/** Returns one form with its questions in order, or null if it is missing. */
export async function getForm(id: string): Promise<Form | null> {
  const row = await prisma.form.findUnique({
    where: { id },
    include: { questions: { orderBy: { position: 'asc' } } },
  });
  if (!row) {
    return null;
  }
  // Parsing catches a bad row on the server instead of in the browser.
  return formSchema.parse({ ...row, createdAt: row.createdAt.toISOString() });
}

/** Creates a form and its questions in one nested write. */
export async function createForm(input: CreateFormInput): Promise<Form> {
  const row = await prisma.form.create({
    data: {
      title: input.title,
      description: input.description ?? null,
      questions: {
        create: input.questions.map((q, position) => ({ ...q, position })),
      },
    },
    include: { questions: { orderBy: { position: 'asc' } } },
  });
  return formSchema.parse({ ...row, createdAt: row.createdAt.toISOString() });
}

/** Deletes a form; its questions and submissions go with it. Returns false if missing. */
export async function deleteForm(id: string): Promise<boolean> {
  const result = await prisma.form.deleteMany({ where: { id } });
  return result.count > 0;
}
```

File: `lib/server/repo/postgres/submissions.ts`. Submission data access in Postgres.

```
import { prisma } from '../../db';
import type { Form } from '@/lib/schemas/form';
import type { Submission } from '@/lib/schemas/submission';

type Answers = Record<string, string | string[]>;

/** Returns what was stored so the same row can be mirrored to Firestore. */
export async function createSubmission(
  form: Form,
  answers: Answers,
): Promise<Submission> {
  const rows: {
    questionId: string;
    text: string | null;
    number: number | null;
  }[] = [];
  for (const question of form.questions) {
    const value = answers[question.id];
    if (value === undefined || value === '' || value.length === 0) {
```

```
      continue; // empty answers are not stored
    }
    if (question.type === 'number') {
      rows.push({ questionId: question.id, text: null, number: Number(value) });
    } else {
      const text = Array.isArray(value) ? JSON.stringify(value) : value;
      rows.push({ questionId: question.id, text, number: null });
    }
  }
  // One nested create is a single transaction.
  const saved = await prisma.submission.create({
    data: { formId: form.id, answers: { create: rows } },
  });
  return {
    id: saved.id,
    createdAt: saved.createdAt.toISOString(),
    answers: toAnswerMap(form, rows),
  };
}

/** Rebuilds the question-id keyed answer map from stored rows. */
function toAnswerMap(
  form: Form,
  rows: { questionId: string; text: string | null; number: number | null }[],
): Answers {
  const map: Answers = {};
  for (const row of rows) {
    const question = form.questions.find((q) => q.id === row.questionId);
    if (row.number !== null) {
      map[row.questionId] = String(row.number);
    } else if (question?.type === 'multi_choice' && row.text) {
      map[row.questionId] = JSON.parse(row.text) as string[];
    } else if (row.text !== null) {
      map[row.questionId] = row.text;
    }
  }
  return map;
}

/** Lists one page of a form's submissions, newest first. */
export async function listSubmissions(form: Form, page: number, limit: number) {
  const [total, rows] = await Promise.all([
    prisma.submission.count({ where: { formId: form.id } }),
    prisma.submission.findMany({
      where: { formId: form.id },
      orderBy: { createdAt: 'desc' },
      skip: (page - 1) * limit,
      take: limit,
      include: { answers: true },
    }),
  ]);
  const items: Submission[] = rows.map((row) => ({
    id: row.id,
    createdAt: row.createdAt.toISOString(),
    answers: toAnswerMap(form, row.answers),
  }));
  return { items, page, limit, total };
}

/** Every submission of a form (used by sync). */
export async function listAllSubmissions(form: Form): Promise<Submission[]> {
  const rows = await prisma.submission.findMany({
    where: { formId: form.id },
    include: { answers: true },
  });
```

```
  return rows.map((row) => ({
    id: row.id,
    createdAt: row.createdAt.toISOString(),
    answers: toAnswerMap(form, row.answers),
  }));
}
```

File: `lib/server/repo/firestore/forms.ts`. Form mirror writes and reads in Firestore.

```
import { getDb } from '../../firestore';
import { formSchema, type Form, type FormSummary } from '@/lib/schemas/form';

/** Copies a form to Firestore under the same id. Keeps the response counter. */
export async function mirrorForm(form: Form, responseCount?: number) {
  const ref = getDb().collection('forms').doc(form.id);
  const data: Record<string, unknown> = { ...form };
  if (responseCount !== undefined) {
    data.responseCount = responseCount;
  }
  await ref.set(data, { merge: true });
  if (responseCount === undefined) {
    // Set the counter only when the document has none yet.
    await getDb().runTransaction(async (tx) => {
      const snap = await tx.get(ref);
      if (snap.get('responseCount') === undefined) {
        tx.update(ref, { responseCount: 0 });
      }
    });
  }
}

export async function deleteMirroredForm(id: string) {
  const ref = getDb().collection('forms').doc(id);
  await getDb().recursiveDelete(ref);
}

export async function listMirroredForms(): Promise<FormSummary[]> {
  const snap = await getDb()
    .collection('forms')
    .orderBy('createdAt', 'desc')
    .get();
  return snap.docs.map((doc) => ({
    id: doc.id,
    title: doc.get('title'),
    createdAt: doc.get('createdAt'),
    questionCount: (doc.get('questions') ?? []).length,
    responseCount: doc.get('responseCount') ?? 0,
  }));
}

export async function getMirroredForm(id: string): Promise<Form | null> {
  const snap = await getDb().collection('forms').doc(id).get();
  if (!snap.exists) {
    return null;
  }
  return formSchema.parse({ ...snap.data(), id: snap.id });
}

export async function listMirroredFormIds(): Promise<string[]> {
  const snap = await getDb().collection('forms').select().get();
  return snap.docs.map((doc) => doc.id);
}
```

File: `lib/server/repo/firestore/submissions.ts`. Submission mirror writes and reads in Firestore.

```
import { FieldValue } from 'firebase-admin/firestore';
import { getDb } from '../../firestore';
import type { Submission } from '@/lib/schemas/submission';

/**
 * Writes the submission and bumps the form counter in one transaction, and
 * only if the document did not exist, so mirroring twice counts once.
 */
export async function mirrorSubmission(formId: string, submission: Submission) {
  const db = getDb();
  const formRef = db.collection('forms').doc(formId);
  const ref = formRef.collection('submissions').doc(submission.id);
  await db.runTransaction(async (tx) => {
    const existing = await tx.get(ref);
    tx.set(ref, submission);
    if (!existing.exists) {
      tx.set(
        formRef,
        { responseCount: FieldValue.increment(1) },
        { merge: true },
      );
    }
  });
}

export async function listMirroredSubmissions(
  formId: string,
  page: number,
  limit: number,
) {
  const col = getDb().collection('forms').doc(formId).collection('submissions');
  const [totalSnap, snap] = await Promise.all([
    col.count().get(),
    col
      .orderBy('createdAt', 'desc')
      .offset((page - 1) * limit)
      .limit(limit)
      .get(),
  ]);
  const items = snap.docs.map((doc) => doc.data() as Submission);
  return { items, page, limit, total: totalSnap.data().count };
}

export async function countMirroredSubmissions(
  formId: string,
): Promise<number> {
  const col = getDb().collection('forms').doc(formId).collection('submissions');
  return (await col.count().get()).data().count;
}
```

File: `lib/server/repo/dual.ts`. Safe mirror write and read with fallback.

```
/**
 * Runs a Firestore mirror write. A failure is logged and swallowed, because
 * the response is already correct; the sync endpoint repairs the difference.
 */
export async function mirrorSafely(
  task: () => Promise<unknown>,
): Promise<void> {
  try {
    await task();
```

```
  } catch (error) {
    console.error('Firestore mirror failed', error);
  }
}

/**
 * Reads from Postgres. If Postgres throws (for example it is unreachable),
 * the same read runs against Firestore. A "not found" (null) is a real
 * answer and is not retried.
 */
export async function readWithFallback<T>(
  primary: () => Promise<T>,
  fallback: () => Promise<T>,
): Promise<T> {
  try {
    return await primary();
  } catch (error) {
    console.error('Postgres read failed, using Firestore', error);
    return fallback();
  }
}
```

File: `lib/server/repo/forms.ts`. Form facade: Postgres first, then mirror.

```
import type { CreateFormInput } from '@/lib/schemas/form';
import { mirrorSafely, readWithFallback } from './dual';
import * as firestore from './firestore/forms';
import * as postgres from './postgres/forms';

export function listForms() {
  return readWithFallback(postgres.listForms, firestore.listMirroredForms);
}

export function getForm(id: string) {
  return readWithFallback(
    () => postgres.getForm(id),
    () => firestore.getMirroredForm(id),
  );
}

/** Postgres first, then the mirror. */
export async function createForm(input: CreateFormInput) {
  const form = await postgres.createForm(input);
  await mirrorSafely(() => firestore.mirrorForm(form));
  return form;
}

export async function deleteForm(id: string) {
  const deleted = await postgres.deleteForm(id);
  if (deleted) {
    await mirrorSafely(() => firestore.deleteMirroredForm(id));
  }
  return deleted;
}
```

File: `lib/server/repo/submissions.ts`. Submission facade: Postgres first, then mirror.

```
import type { Form } from '@/lib/schemas/form';
import { mirrorSafely, readWithFallback } from './dual';
import * as firestore from './firestore/submissions';
import * as postgres from './postgres/submissions';

/** Postgres first, then the mirror. */
export async function createSubmission(
```

```
  form: Form,
  answers: Record<string, string | string[]>,
) {
  const submission = await postgres.createSubmission(form, answers);
  await mirrorSafely(() => firestore.mirrorSubmission(form.id, submission));
  return submission;
}

export function listSubmissions(form: Form, page: number, limit: number) {
  return readWithFallback(
    () => postgres.listSubmissions(form, page, limit),
    () => firestore.listMirroredSubmissions(form.id, page, limit),
  );
}
```

File: `lib/server/repo/files.ts`. Uploaded files stored in Firestore.

```
import { randomUUID } from 'node:crypto';
import { getDb } from '../firestore';

type StoredFile = { name: string; type: string; data: string };

/** Saves a file as a Firestore document and returns its random id. */
export async function saveFile(file: File): Promise<string> {
  const id = randomUUID().replace(/-/g, '');
  const bytes = Buffer.from(await file.arrayBuffer());
  const doc: StoredFile = {
    name: file.name,
    type: file.type,
    data: bytes.toString('base64'),
  };
  await getDb().collection('files').doc(id).set(doc);
  return id;
}

/** Loads a stored file, or null if the id is unknown. */
export async function loadFile(id: string) {
  const snap = await getDb().collection('files').doc(id).get();
  if (!snap.exists) {
    return null;
  }
  const doc = snap.data() as StoredFile;
  return {
    name: doc.name,
    type: doc.type,
    bytes: Buffer.from(doc.data, 'base64'),
  };
}

export async function fileExists(id: string): Promise<boolean> {
  return (await getDb().collection('files').doc(id).get()).exists;
}
```

File: `lib/server/repo/sync.ts`. Sync status and full repair.

```
import { prisma } from '../db';
import * as firestoreForms from './firestore/forms';
import * as firestoreSubmissions from './firestore/submissions';
import * as postgresForms from './postgres/forms';
import * as postgresSubmissions from './postgres/submissions';

/**
 * Compares both databases by id, not only by count: counts alone say
 * "in sync" when one form was deleted and another added.
```

```
 */
export async function getSyncStatus() {
  const [pgIds, fsIds] = await Promise.all([
    prisma.form
      .findMany({ select: { id: true } })
      .then((r) => r.map((f) => f.id)),
    firestoreForms.listMirroredFormIds(),
  ]);
  const missingInFirestore = pgIds.filter((id) => !fsIds.includes(id));
  const onlyInFirestore = fsIds.filter((id) => !pgIds.includes(id));
  const pgSubmissions = await prisma.submission.count();
  let fsSubmissions = 0;
  for (const id of fsIds) {
    fsSubmissions += await firestoreSubmissions.countMirroredSubmissions(id);
  }
  return {
    missingInFirestore,
    onlyInFirestore,
    submissions: { postgres: pgSubmissions, firestore: fsSubmissions },
    inSync:
      missingInFirestore.length === 0 &&
      onlyInFirestore.length === 0 &&
      pgSubmissions === fsSubmissions,
  };
}

/** Copies everything from Postgres to Firestore. Safe to repeat. */
export async function syncAll() {
  const summaries = await postgresForms.listForms();
  let submissionCount = 0;
  for (const summary of summaries) {
    const form = await postgresForms.getForm(summary.id);
    if (!form) {
      continue;
    }
    const submissions = await postgresSubmissions.listAllSubmissions(form);
    for (const submission of submissions) {
      await firestoreSubmissions.mirrorSubmission(form.id, submission);
    }
    // Why last: it sets the counter to the real number, whatever the
    // submission mirrors incremented along the way.
    await firestoreForms.mirrorForm(form, submissions.length);
    submissionCount += submissions.length;
  }
  const keep = new Set(summaries.map((s) => s.id));
  const stray = (await firestoreForms.listMirroredFormIds()).filter(
    (id) => !keep.has(id),
  );
  for (const id of stray) {
    await firestoreForms.deleteMirroredForm(id);
  }
  return {
    forms: summaries.length,
    submissions: submissionCount,
    removed: stray.length,
  };
}
```

12.5 API routes

File: `lib/server/routes/forms.ts`. Form endpoints and 405 handling.

```
import { Hono } from 'hono';
```

```
import { createFormSchema, formIdParamSchema } from '@/lib/schemas/form';
import { jsonError } from '../errors';
import { methodNotAllowed } from '../methods';
import { createForm, deleteForm, getForm, listForms } from '../repo/forms';
import { validate } from '../validate';

export const forms = new Hono();

forms.get('/', async (c) => c.json(await listForms()));

forms.post('/', validate('json', createFormSchema), async (c) => {
  const form = await createForm(c.req.valid('json'));
  return c.json(form, 201);
});
methodNotAllowed(forms, '/', ['GET', 'POST']);

forms.get('/:id', validate('param', formIdParamSchema), async (c) => {
  const form = await getForm(c.req.valid('param').id);
  return form ? c.json(form) : jsonError(c, 404, 'not_found', 'Form not found');
});

forms.delete('/:id', validate('param', formIdParamSchema), async (c) => {
  const deleted = await deleteForm(c.req.valid('param').id);
  return deleted
    ? c.body(null, 204)
    : jsonError(c, 404, 'not_found', 'Form not found');
});
methodNotAllowed(forms, '/:id', ['GET', 'DELETE']);
```

File: `lib/server/routes/submissions.ts`. Submission endpoints and 405 handling.

```
import { Hono } from 'hono';
import { formIdParamSchema } from '@/lib/schemas/form';
import {
  answersPayloadSchema,
  buildAnswerSchema,
  pageQuerySchema,
} from '@/lib/schemas/submission';
import { errorBody, jsonError } from '../errors';
import { methodNotAllowed } from '../methods';
import { getForm } from '../repo/forms';
import { fileExists } from '../repo/files';
import { createSubmission, listSubmissions } from '../repo/submissions';
import { validate } from '../validate';

export const submissions = new Hono();

submissions.post(
  '/:id/submissions',
  validate('param', formIdParamSchema),
  async (c) => {
    const form = await getForm(c.req.valid('param').id);
    if (!form) {
      return jsonError(c, 404, 'not_found', 'Form not found');
    }
    // A body that is not JSON becomes null and fails validation with a 400.
    const body = await c.req.json().catch(() => null);
    const shape = answersPayloadSchema.safeParse(body);
    if (!shape.success) {
      return c.json(errorBody('invalid_request', 'Invalid request'), 400);
    }
    // Why per request: the rules come from this form's own questions.
    const result = buildAnswerSchema(form.questions).safeParse(
      shape.data.answers,
```

```
    );
    if (!result.success) {
      const issues = result.error.issues.map((i) => ({
        path: i.path.join('.'),
        message: i.message,
      }));
      return c.json(
        errorBody('invalid_answers', 'Some answers are invalid', issues),
        400,
      );
    }
    const answers = result.data as Record<string, string | string[]>;
    // Every file answer must be the id of a file this app stored.
    for (const question of form.questions) {
      const value = answers[question.id];
      if (
        question.type === 'file' &&
        typeof value === 'string' &&
        value !== ''
      ) {
        if (!(await fileExists(value))) {
          return c.json(
            errorBody('invalid_answers', 'Unknown file', [
              { path: question.id, message: 'Unknown file' },
            ]),
            400,
          );
        }
      }
    }
    const saved = await createSubmission(form, answers);
    return c.json({ id: saved.id }, 201);
  },
);

submissions.get(
  '/:id/submissions',
  validate('param', formIdParamSchema),
  validate('query', pageQuerySchema),
  async (c) => {
    const form = await getForm(c.req.valid('param').id);
    if (!form) {
      return jsonError(c, 404, 'not_found', 'Form not found');
    }
    const { page, limit } = c.req.valid('query');
    const result = await listSubmissions(form, page, limit);
    // File answers become download paths.
    const fileIds = new Set(
      form.questions.filter((q) => q.type === 'file').map((q) => q.id),
    );
    const items = result.items.map((item) => ({
      ...item,
      answers: Object.fromEntries(
        Object.entries(item.answers).map(([key, value]) => [
          key,
          fileIds.has(key) && typeof value === 'string' && value
            ? `/api/files/${value}`
            : value,
        ]),
      ),
    }));
    return c.json({ ...result, items });
  },
);
methodNotAllowed(submissions, '/:id/submissions', ['GET', 'POST']);
```

File: `lib/server/routes/files.ts`. File upload and download.

```
import { Hono } from 'hono';
import {
  ALLOWED_FILE_TYPES,
  MAX_FILE_BYTES,
  fileIdParamSchema,
} from '@/lib/schemas/upload';
import { errorBody, jsonError } from '../errors';
import { methodNotAllowed } from '../methods';
import { loadFile, saveFile } from '../repo/files';
import { validate } from '../validate';

export const files = new Hono();

files.post('/', async (c) => {
  const form = await c.req.formData().catch(() => null);
  const file = form?.get('file');
  if (!(file instanceof File)) {
    return c.json(
      errorBody('invalid_request', 'Send a multipart field "file"'),
      400,
    );
  }
  // Re-checked here because the browser check can be skipped.
  if (!(ALLOWED_FILE_TYPES as readonly string[]).includes(file.type)) {
    return c.json(
      errorBody('invalid_file', 'This file type is not allowed'),
      400,
    );
  }
  if (file.size > MAX_FILE_BYTES) {
    return c.json(
      errorBody('invalid_file', 'The file is larger than 700 KB'),
      400,
    );
  }
  return c.json({ id: await saveFile(file) }, 201);
});
methodNotAllowed(files, '/', ['POST']);

files.get('/:id', validate('param', fileIdParamSchema), async (c) => {
  const stored = await loadFile(c.req.valid('param').id);
  if (!stored) {
    return jsonError(c, 404, 'not_found', 'File not found');
  }
  // An attachment plus nosniff, so an upload is never run as a page here.
  return new Response(new Uint8Array(stored.bytes), {
    headers: {
      'Content-Type': stored.type,
      'Content-Disposition': `attachment; filename="${encodeURIComponent(stored.name)}"`,
      'X-Content-Type-Options': 'nosniff',
    },
  });
});
methodNotAllowed(files, '/:id', ['GET']);
```

File: `lib/server/routes/sync.ts`. Token-protected sync endpoints.

```
import { Hono } from 'hono';
import { getSyncToken } from '../env';
import { jsonError } from '../errors';
import { methodNotAllowed } from '../methods';
import { getSyncStatus, syncAll } from '../repo/sync';
```

```
export const sync = new Hono();

// Why: these routes can rewrite a whole database and reveal counts. With no
// token configured they stay closed.
sync.use('*', async (c, next) => {
  const token = getSyncToken();
  if (!token || c.req.header('Authorization') !== `Bearer ${token}`) {
    return jsonError(c, 401, 'unauthorized', 'Missing or wrong token');
  }
  await next();
});

sync.get('/status', async (c) => c.json(await getSyncStatus()));
methodNotAllowed(sync, '/status', ['GET']);

sync.post('/', async (c) => c.json(await syncAll()));
methodNotAllowed(sync, '/', ['POST']);
```

File: `lib/server/app.ts`. The Hono app: routes, 404 and error handler.

```
import { Hono } from 'hono';
import { jsonError } from './errors';
import { files } from './routes/files';
import { forms } from './routes/forms';
import { submissions } from './routes/submissions';
import { sync } from './routes/sync';

export const app = new Hono().basePath('/api');

app.route('/forms', forms);
app.route('/forms', submissions);
app.route('/files', files);
app.route('/sync', sync);

// An unknown path returns a JSON 404.
app.notFound((c) => jsonError(c, 404, 'not_found', 'No such route'));

// An unexpected failure returns a generic 500; the real error is only logged.
app.onError((error, c) => {
  console.error(error);
  return jsonError(c, 500, 'internal_error', 'Something went wrong');
});
```

File: `app/api/[[...route]]/route.ts`. Mounts Hono inside Next.js.

```
import { handle } from 'hono/vercel';
import { app } from '@/lib/server/app';

// Every method is exported on purpose: Next.js answers an unexported method
// with its own empty 405, while Hono answers with the JSON 405 and Allow.
// There is no `runtime` export, because Cache Components rejects it.
export const GET = handle(app);
export const POST = handle(app);
export const PUT = handle(app);
export const PATCH = handle(app);
export const DELETE = handle(app);
export const OPTIONS = handle(app);
```

12.6 Client library

File: `lib/fetch.ts`. Typed HTTP client and error message helper.

```
import {
  BetterFetchError,
  createFetch,
  createSchema,
} from '@better-fetch/fetch';
import { z } from 'zod';
import {
  createFormSchema,
  formIdParamSchema,
  formSchema,
  formSummarySchema,
} from '@/lib/schemas/form';
import {
  answersPayloadSchema,
  pageQuerySchema,
  submissionsPageSchema,
} from '@/lib/schemas/submission';
import {
  uploadResultSchema,
  MAX_FILE_BYTES,
  ALLOWED_FILE_TYPES,
} from '@/lib/schemas/upload';

const idResult = z.object({ id: z.string() });

/** Every JSON endpoint with its schemas: a wrong URL or body is a type error. */
const schema = createSchema({
  '/forms': { output: z.array(formSummarySchema) },
  '@post/forms': { input: createFormSchema, output: formSchema },
  '/forms/:id': { params: formIdParamSchema, output: formSchema },
  '@delete/forms/:id': { params: formIdParamSchema },
  '/forms/:id/submissions': {
    params: formIdParamSchema,
    query: pageQuerySchema.partial(),
    output: submissionsPageSchema,
  },
  '@post/forms/:id/submissions': {
    params: formIdParamSchema,
    input: answersPayloadSchema,
    output: idResult,
  },
});

/** better-fetch needs an absolute base URL; requests only run in the browser. */
function apiBase(): string {
  const origin =
    typeof window === 'undefined'
      ? 'http://localhost:3000'
      : window.location.origin;
  return `${origin}/api`;
}

export const api = createFetch({ baseURL: apiBase(), schema, throw: true });

/** Reads the server's error message, or falls back to a generic one. */
export function getErrorMessage(error: unknown): string {
  if (error instanceof BetterFetchError) {
    const body = error.error as { error?: { message?: string } } | undefined;
    return body?.error?.message ?? error.statusText ?? 'Request failed';
  }
  return error instanceof Error ? error.message : 'Something went wrong';
```

```
}

/**
 * Plain fetch with FormData: a multipart body cannot be described by a Zod
 * input schema. The response is still parsed with a schema.
 */
export async function uploadFile(file: File): Promise<string> {
  if (!(ALLOWED_FILE_TYPES as readonly string[]).includes(file.type)) {
    throw new Error('This file type is not allowed');
  }
  if (file.size > MAX_FILE_BYTES) {
    throw new Error('The file is larger than 700 KB');
  }
  const body = new FormData();
  body.append('file', file);
  const response = await fetch(`${apiBase()}/files`, { method: 'POST', body });
  const json: unknown = await response.json();
  if (!response.ok) {
    throw new BetterFetchError(response.status, response.statusText, json);
  }
  return uploadResultSchema.parse(json).id;
}
```

File: `lib/useLoad.ts`. Loading hook.

```
'use client';

import { useCallback, useEffect, useState } from 'react';
import { getErrorMessage } from './fetch';

type LoadState<T> = {
  data: T | null;
  error: string | null;
  loading: boolean;
  reload: () => void;
};

/** Runs an async loader and reports loading, error or data. */
export function useLoad<T>(
  loader: () => Promise<T>,
  deps: unknown[],
): LoadState<T> {
  const [data, setData] = useState<T | null>(null);
  const [error, setError] = useState<string | null>(null);
  const [loading, setLoading] = useState(true);
  const [version, setVersion] = useState(0);

  // eslint-disable-next-line react-hooks/exhaustive-deps
  const run = useCallback(loader, deps);

  useEffect(() => {
    let cancelled = false;
    run()
      .then((value) => {
        if (!cancelled) {
          setData(value);
          setError(null);
          setLoading(false);
        }
      })
      .catch((e: unknown) => {
        if (!cancelled) {
          setError(getErrorMessage(e));
          setLoading(false);
```

```
        }
      });
    return () => {
      cancelled = true;
    };
  }, [run, version]);

  return { data, error, loading, reload: () => setVersion((v) => v + 1) };
}
```

File: `lib/schemas/builder.ts`. Builder-only schema and conversion to the API payload.

```
import { z } from 'zod';
import { createFormSchema, type CreateFormInput } from './form';
import { isChoiceType, questionTypeSchema } from './question';

/**
 * Client-only. react-hook-form field arrays need objects, so options are
 * `{ value }` here and become plain strings in the API payload.
 */
export const builderFormSchema = z.object({
  title: z.string().trim().min(1, 'Title is required'),
  description: z.string().optional(),
  questions: z
    .array(
      z.object({
        label: z.string().trim().min(1, 'Question text is required'),
        type: questionTypeSchema,
        required: z.boolean(),
        options: z.array(z.object({ value: z.string() })),
      }),
    )
    .min(1, 'Add at least one question'),
});

export type BuilderForm = z.infer<typeof builderFormSchema>;

/** Converts the builder state to the payload the API accepts. */
export function toCreateFormPayload(values: BuilderForm): CreateFormInput {
  return createFormSchema.parse({
    title: values.title,
    description: values.description || undefined,
    questions: values.questions.map((q) => ({
      label: q.label,
      type: q.type,
      required: q.required,
      options: isChoiceType(q.type)
        ? q.options.map((o) => o.value).filter((v) => v.trim() !== '')
        : [],
    })),
  });
}
```

File: `lib/responsive/pattrens/forms.ts`. All Tailwind class strings.

```
/** Every Tailwind class string, one object per component. */

export const page = {
  main: 'mx-auto w-full max-w-3xl px-4 py-8',
  heading: 'mb-6 text-2xl font-semibold',
  muted: 'text-sm text-zinc-500',
  error: 'text-sm text-red-600',
};
```

```
export const shared = {
  input:
    'w-full rounded border border-zinc-300 px-3 py-2 text-sm focus:border-blue-500 focus:outline-
    none',
  label: 'mb-1 block text-sm font-medium',
  button:
    'rounded bg-blue-600 px-4 py-2 text-sm font-medium text-white hover:bg-blue-700 disabled:
    opacity-50',
  buttonGhost:
    'rounded border border-zinc-300 px-3 py-1.5 text-sm hover:bg-zinc-100',
  link: 'text-blue-600 hover:underline',
};

export const builder = {
  form: 'space-y-6',
  card: 'space-y-3 rounded border border-zinc-200 p-4',
  row: 'flex items-center gap-2',
  checkbox: 'h-4 w-4',
};

export const survey = {
  form: 'space-y-5',
  field: 'space-y-1',
  options: 'space-y-1',
  option: 'flex items-center gap-2 text-sm',
};

export const list = {
  header: 'mb-6 flex items-center justify-between',
  item: 'flex items-center justify-between border-b border-zinc-200 py-3',
  actions: 'flex gap-4 text-sm',
};

export const table = {
  wrap: 'overflow-x-auto',
  table: 'w-full border-collapse text-left text-sm',
  th: 'border-b border-zinc-300 px-3 py-2 font-medium',
  td: 'border-b border-zinc-200 px-3 py-2 align-top',
  pager: 'mt-4 flex items-center gap-3 text-sm',
};
```

12.7 Components

File: `components/FormBuilder.tsx`. Create-form screen.

```
'use client';

import { zodResolver } from '@hookform/resolvers/zod';
import { useRouter } from 'next/navigation';
import { useState } from 'react';
import { useFieldArray, useForm } from 'react-hook-form';
import { api, getErrorMessage } from '@/lib/fetch';
import { builder as p, page, shared } from '@/lib/responsive/pattrens/forms';
import {
  builderFormSchema,
  toCreateFormPayload,
  type BuilderForm,
} from '@/lib/schemas/builder';
import { isChoiceType, questionTypes } from '@/lib/schemas/question';
import { OptionsEditor } from './OptionsEditor';

const emptyQuestion: BuilderForm['questions'][number] = {
  label: '',
```

```
  type: 'short_text',
  required: false,
  options: [],
};

/** Create a form: react-hook-form with a field array and builderFormSchema. */
export function FormBuilder() {
  const router = useRouter();
  const [serverError, setServerError] = useState<string | null>(null);
  const {
    register,
    control,
    handleSubmit,
    watch,
    formState: { errors, isSubmitting },
  } = useForm<BuilderForm>({
    resolver: zodResolver(builderFormSchema),
    defaultValues: { title: '', description: '', questions: [emptyQuestion] },
  });
  const { fields, append, remove } = useFieldArray({
    control,
    name: 'questions',
  });

  /** Sends the payload; on success go to the dashboard. */
  async function onSubmit(values: BuilderForm) {
    setServerError(null);
    try {
      await api('@post/forms', { body: toCreateFormPayload(values) });
      router.push('/');
    } catch (error) {
      setServerError(getErrorMessage(error));
    }
  }

  return (
    <form className={p.form} onSubmit={handleSubmit(onSubmit)}>
      <div>
        <label className={shared.label}>Title</label>
        <input className={shared.input} {...register('title')} />
        {errors.title && <p className={page.error}>{errors.title.message}</p>}
      </div>
      <div>
        <label className={shared.label}>Description</label>
        <textarea className={shared.input} {...register('description')} />
      </div>

      {fields.map((field, index) => {
        const type = watch(`questions.${index}.type`);
        return (
          <div key={field.id} className={p.card}>
            <input
              className={shared.input}
              placeholder="Question"
              {...register(`questions.${index}.label`)}
            />
            {errors.questions?.[index]?.label && (
              <p className={page.error}>
                {errors.questions[index]?.label?.message}
              </p>
            )}
            <div className={p.row}>
              <select
                className={shared.input}
                {...register(`questions.${index}.type`)}
```

```
              >
                {questionTypes.map((t) => (
                  <option key={t} value={t}>
                    {t.replace('_', ' ')}
                  </option>
                ))}
              </select>
              <label className={p.row}>
                <input
                  type="checkbox"
                  className={p.checkbox}
                  {...register(`questions.${index}.required`)}
                />
                Required
              </label>
              <button
                type="button"
                className={shared.buttonGhost}
                onClick={() => remove(index)}
              >
                Delete
              </button>
            </div>
            {isChoiceType(type) && (
              <OptionsEditor
                index={index}
                control={control}
                register={register}
              />
            )}
          </div>
        );
      })}

      <button
        type="button"
        className={shared.buttonGhost}
        onClick={() => append(emptyQuestion)}
      >
        Add question
      </button>
      {serverError && <p className={page.error}>{serverError}</p>}
      <div>
        <button type="submit" className={shared.button} disabled={isSubmitting}>
          {isSubmitting ? 'Saving...' : 'Create form'}
        </button>
      </div>
    </form>
  );
}
```

File: `components/OptionsEditor.tsx`. Options editor for choice questions.

```
'use client';

import {
  useFieldArray,
  type Control,
  type UseFormRegister,
} from 'react-hook-form';
import type { BuilderForm } from '@/lib/schemas/builder';
import { builder as p, shared } from '@/lib/responsive/pattrens/forms';

type Props = {
```

```
  index: number;
  control: Control<BuilderForm>;
  register: UseFormRegister<BuilderForm>;
};

/** Choices of one question: one input per option, add, remove, Yes / No. */
export function OptionsEditor({ index, control, register }: Props) {
  const { fields, append, remove, replace } = useFieldArray({
    control,
    name: `questions.${index}.options`,
  });

  return (
    <div className="space-y-2">
      {fields.map((field, optionIndex) => (
        <div key={field.id} className={p.row}>
          <input
            className={shared.input}
            placeholder={`Option ${optionIndex + 1}`}
            {...register(`questions.${index}.options.${optionIndex}.value`)}
          />
          <button
            type="button"
            className={shared.buttonGhost}
            onClick={() => remove(optionIndex)}
          >
            Remove
          </button>
        </div>
      ))}
      <div className={p.row}>
        <button
          type="button"
          className={shared.buttonGhost}
          onClick={() => append({ value: '' })}
        >
          Add option
        </button>
        <button
          type="button"
          className={shared.buttonGhost}
          onClick={() => replace([{ value: 'Yes' }, { value: 'No' }])}
        >
          Yes / No
        </button>
      </div>
    </div>
  );
}
```

File: `components/QuestionField.tsx`. One input per question type.

```
'use client';

import { Controller, type Control, type FieldValues } from 'react-hook-form';
import { page, shared, survey as p } from '@/lib/responsive/pattrens/forms';
import type { Question } from '@/lib/schemas/question';
import { FileUploadField } from './FileUploadField';

type Props = {
  question: Question;
  control: Control<FieldValues>;
  error?: string;
};
```

```
const inputTypes: Record<string, string> = {
  short_text: 'text',
  number: 'number',
  email: 'email',
  date: 'date',
};

/** One input per question type. */
export function QuestionField({ question, control, error }: Props) {
  return (
    <div className={p.field}>
      <label className={shared.label}>
        {question.label}
        {question.required && ' *'}
      </label>
      <Controller
        control={control}
        name={question.id}
        render={({ field }) => {
          switch (question.type) {
            case 'long_text':
              return (
                <textarea
                  className={shared.input}
                  {...field}
                  value={field.value ?? ''}
                />
              );
            case 'single_choice':
              return (
                <div className={p.options}>
                  {question.options.map((option) => (
                    <label key={option} className={p.option}>
                      <input
                        type="radio"
                        checked={field.value === option}
                        onChange={() => field.onChange(option)}
                      />
                      {option}
                    </label>
                  ))}
                </div>
              );
            case 'multi_choice': {
              const selected: string[] = field.value ?? [];
              return (
                <div className={p.options}>
                  {question.options.map((option) => (
                    <label key={option} className={p.option}>
                      <input
                        type="checkbox"
                        checked={selected.includes(option)}
                        onChange={(e) =>
                          field.onChange(
                            e.target.checked
                              ? [...selected, option]
                              : selected.filter((o) => o !== option),
                          )
                        }
                      />
                      {option}
                    </label>
                  ))}
                </div>
```

```
            );
          }
          case 'file':
            return (
              <FileUploadField
                value={field.value ?? ''}
                onChange={field.onChange}
              />
            );
          default:
            return (
              <input
                className={shared.input}
                type={inputTypes[question.type] ?? 'text'}
                {...field}
                value={field.value ?? ''}
              />
            );
        }
      }}
    />
    {error && <p className={page.error}>{error}</p>}
  </div>
 );
}
```

File: `components/FileUploadField.tsx`. File picker and upload.

```
'use client';

import { useState } from 'react';
import { getErrorMessage, uploadFile } from '@/lib/fetch';
import { page, shared } from '@/lib/responsive/pattrens/forms';

type Props = { value: string; onChange: (id: string) => void };

/** Checks the file, uploads it to /api/files, stores the returned id. */
export function FileUploadField({ value, onChange }: Props) {
  const [status, setStatus] = useState<string | null>(null);
  const [error, setError] = useState<string | null>(null);

  async function onPick(file: File | undefined) {
    if (!file) {
      return;
    }
    setError(null);
    setStatus('Uploading...');
    try {
      onChange(await uploadFile(file));
      setStatus(`Uploaded ${file.name}`);
    } catch (e) {
      setStatus(null);
      setError(getErrorMessage(e));
    }
  }

  return (
    <div>
      <input
        type="file"
        className={shared.input}
        onChange={(event) => onPick(event.target.files?.[0])}
      />
      {value && status && <p className={page.muted}>{status}</p>}
```

```
      {error && <p className={page.error}>{error}</p>}
    </div>
  );
}
```

File: `components/SurveyForm.tsx`. Public survey form.

```
'use client';

import { zodResolver } from '@hookform/resolvers/zod';
import { useMemo, useState } from 'react';
import { useForm, type FieldValues } from 'react-hook-form';
import { api, getErrorMessage } from '@/lib/fetch';
import { page, shared, survey as p } from '@/lib/responsive/pattrens/forms';
import type { Form } from '@/lib/schemas/form';
import { buildAnswerSchema } from '@/lib/schemas/submission';
import { QuestionField } from './QuestionField';

/** Fills in a survey with a schema built from its questions, then submits. */
export function SurveyForm({ form }: { form: Form }) {
  const [done, setDone] = useState(false);
  const [serverError, setServerError] = useState<string | null>(null);
  // The same rules the API applies, built from this form's own questions.
  const schema = useMemo(
    () => buildAnswerSchema(form.questions),
    [form.questions],
  );
  const defaults = useMemo(
    () =>
      Object.fromEntries(
        form.questions.map((q) => [q.id, q.type === 'multi_choice' ? [] : '']),
      ),
    [form.questions],
  );
  const {
    control,
    handleSubmit,
    formState: { errors, isSubmitting },
  } = useForm<FieldValues>({
    // The generic schema is checked on the server again.
    resolver: zodResolver(schema as never),
    defaultValues: defaults,
  });

  async function onSubmit(answers: FieldValues) {
    setServerError(null);
    try {
      await api('@post/forms/:id/submissions', {
        params: { id: form.id },
        body: { answers },
      });
      setDone(true);
    } catch (error) {
      setServerError(getErrorMessage(error));
    }
  }

  if (done) {
    return <p>Thank you. Your response was recorded.</p>;
  }

  return (
    <form className={p.form} onSubmit={handleSubmit(onSubmit)}>
      {form.questions.map((question) => (
```

```
        <QuestionField
          key={question.id}
          question={question}
          control={control}
          error={errors[question.id]?.message as string | undefined}
        />
      ))}
      {serverError && <p className={page.error}>{serverError}</p>}
      <button type="submit" className={shared.button} disabled={isSubmitting}>
        Submit
      </button>
    </form>
  );
}
```

File: `components/SurveyLoader.tsx`. Loads a form for the public page.

```
'use client';

import { api } from '@/lib/fetch';
import { page } from '@/lib/responsive/pattrens/forms';
import { useLoad } from '@/lib/useLoad';
import { SurveyForm } from './SurveyForm';

/** Loads a form for the public page. */
export function SurveyLoader({ formId }: { formId: string }) {
  const { data, error, loading } = useLoad(
    () => api('/forms/:id', { params: { id: formId } }),
    [formId],
  );
  if (loading) {
    return <p className={page.muted}>Loading...</p>;
  }
  if (error || !data) {
    return <p className={page.error}>{error ?? 'Form not found'}</p>;
  }
  return (
    <>
      <h1 className={page.heading}>{data.title}</h1>
      {data.description && <p className={page.muted}>{data.description}</p>}
      <SurveyForm form={data} />
    </>
  );
}
```

File: `components/FormList.tsx`. Dashboard list.

```
'use client';

import Link from 'next/link';
import { api } from '@/lib/fetch';
import { list, page, shared } from '@/lib/responsive/pattrens/forms';
import { useLoad } from '@/lib/useLoad';

/** Dashboard list with links to the survey and its responses. */
export function FormList() {
  const { data, error, loading } = useLoad(() => api('/forms'), []);
  if (loading) {
    return <p className={page.muted}>Loading...</p>;
  }
  if (error || !data) {
    return <p className={page.error}>{error}</p>;
  }
  if (data.length === 0) {
```

```
    return <p className={page.muted}>No forms yet.</p>;
  }
  return (
    <ul>
      {data.map((form) => (
        <li key={form.id} className={list.item}>
          <div>
            <div>{form.title}</div>
            <div className={page.muted}>
              {form.questionCount} questions, {form.responseCount} responses
            </div>
          </div>
          <div className={list.actions}>
            <Link className={shared.link} href={`/f/${form.id}`}>
              Open
            </Link>
            <Link className={shared.link} href={`/forms/${form.id}/responses`}>
              Responses
            </Link>
          </div>
        </li>
      ))}
    </ul>
  );
}
```

File: `components/ResponsesView.tsx`. Responses table with paging.

```
'use client';

import { useState } from 'react';
import { api } from '@/lib/fetch';
import { page, shared, table as t } from '@/lib/responsive/pattrens/forms';
import { useLoad } from '@/lib/useLoad';

const PAGE_SIZE = 20;

/** Table with one column per question and paging; file answers are links. */
export function ResponsesView({ formId }: { formId: string }) {
  const [pageNumber, setPageNumber] = useState(1);
  const { data, error, loading } = useLoad(async () => {
    const [form, responses] = await Promise.all([
      api('/forms/:id', { params: { id: formId } }),
      api('/forms/:id/submissions', {
        params: { id: formId },
        query: { page: pageNumber, limit: PAGE_SIZE },
      }),
    ]);
    return { form, responses };
  }, [formId, pageNumber]);

  if (loading) {
    return <p className={page.muted}>Loading...</p>;
  }
  if (error || !data) {
    return <p className={page.error}>{error}</p>;
  }
  const { form, responses } = data;
  const pages = Math.max(1, Math.ceil(responses.total / PAGE_SIZE));

  return (
    <>
      <h1 className={page.heading}>{form.title}: responses</h1>
      <div className={t.wrap}>
```

```
        <table className={t.table}>
          <thead>
            <tr>
              <th className={t.th}>Submitted</th>
              {form.questions.map((q) => (
                <th key={q.id} className={t.th}>
                  {q.label}
                </th>
              ))}
            </tr>
          </thead>
          <tbody>
            {responses.items.map((item) => (
              <tr key={item.id}>
                <td className={t.td}>
                  {new Date(item.createdAt).toLocaleString()}
                </td>
                {form.questions.map((q) => {
                  const value = item.answers[q.id];
                  return (
                    <td key={q.id} className={t.td}>
                      {q.type === 'file' && typeof value === 'string' ? (
                        <a className={shared.link} href={value}>
                          Download
                        </a>
                      ) : Array.isArray(value) ? (
                        value.join(', ')
                      ) : (
                        value
                      )}
                    </td>
                  );
                })}
              </tr>
            ))}
          </tbody>
        </table>
      </div>
      <div className={t.pager}>
        <button
          className={shared.buttonGhost}
          disabled={pageNumber <= 1}
          onClick={() => setPageNumber(pageNumber - 1)}
        >
          Previous
        </button>
        <span>
          Page {pageNumber} of {pages}
        </span>
        <button
          className={shared.buttonGhost}
          disabled={pageNumber >= pages}
          onClick={() => setPageNumber(pageNumber + 1)}
        >
          Next
        </button>
      </div>
    </>
  );
}
```

12.8 Pages

File: `app/layout.tsx`. Root layout.

```
import type { Metadata } from 'next';
import './globals.css';

export const metadata: Metadata = {
  title: 'Survey Forms',
  description: 'Build a survey, share a link, collect validated responses.',
};

export default function RootLayout({ children }: LayoutProps<'/'>) {
  return (
    <html lang="en">
      {/* Browser extensions such as Grammarly add attributes before React loads. */}
      <body suppressHydrationWarning>{children}</body>
    </html>
  );
}
```

File: `app/page.tsx`. Dashboard.

```
import Link from 'next/link';
import { FormList } from '@/components/FormList';
import { list, page, shared } from '@/lib/responsive/pattrens/forms';

/** Dashboard: the "New form" button and the list of forms. */
export default function Home() {
  return (
    <main className={page.main}>
      <div className={list.header}>
        <h1 className={page.heading}>Survey forms</h1>
        <Link className={shared.button} href="/forms/new">
          New form
        </Link>
      </div>
      <FormList />
    </main>
  );
}
```

File: `app/forms/new/page.tsx`. Builder page.

```
import { Suspense } from 'react';
import { FormBuilder } from '@/components/FormBuilder';
import { page } from '@/lib/responsive/pattrens/forms';

/** The builder sits inside Suspense: its field array creates random ids. */
export default function NewFormPage() {
  return (
    <main className={page.main}>
      <h1 className={page.heading}>New form</h1>
      <Suspense fallback={<p className={page.muted}>Loading...</p>}>
        <FormBuilder />
      </Suspense>
    </main>
  );
}
```

File: `app/f/[formId]/page.tsx`. Public survey page.

```
import { Suspense } from 'react';
```

```
import { SurveyLoader } from '@/components/SurveyLoader';
import { page } from '@/lib/responsive/pattrens/forms';

/** Params are awaited inside Suspense, as Cache Components requires. */
async function Survey({ params }: PageProps<'/f/[formId]'>) {
  const { formId } = await params;
  return <SurveyLoader formId={formId} />;
}

export default function SurveyPage(props: PageProps<'/f/[formId]'>) {
  return (
    <main className={page.main}>
      <Suspense fallback={<p className={page.muted}>Loading...</p>}>
        <Survey {...props} />
      </Suspense>
    </main>
  );
}
```

File: `app/forms/[id]/responses/page.tsx`. Responses page.

```
import { Suspense } from 'react';
import { ResponsesView } from '@/components/ResponsesView';
import { page } from '@/lib/responsive/pattrens/forms';

/** Params are awaited inside Suspense, as Cache Components requires. */
async function Responses({ params }: PageProps<'/forms/[id]/responses'>) {
  const { id } = await params;
  return <ResponsesView formId={id} />;
}

export default function ResponsesPage(
  props: PageProps<'/forms/[id]/responses'>,
) {
  return (
    <main className={page.main}>
      <Suspense fallback={<p className={page.muted}>Loading...</p>}>
        <Responses {...props} />
      </Suspense>
    </main>
  );
}
```

Appendix: Mermaid Sources

The diagrams above were rendered from these Mermaid sources. They can be pasted into the Mermaid Live Editor, a GitHub README, or any Mermaid-aware viewer.

Database schema (`schema.mmd`)

```
erDiagram
    Form ||--o{ Question : "has (cascade delete)"
    Form ||--o{ Submission : "receives (cascade delete)"
    Submission ||--o{ Answer : "contains (cascade delete)"
    Question ||--o{ Answer : "is answered by (cascade delete)"

    Form {
        string id PK "cuid"
        string title
        string description "optional"
        datetime createdAt
    }
    Question {
        string id PK "cuid"
        string formId FK
        string label
        string type "short_text, long_text, number, email, date, single_choice, multi_choice, file
    "
        boolean required
        string_array options "choices for choice types"
        int position "order inside the form"
    }
    Submission {
        string id PK "cuid"
        string formId FK
        datetime createdAt
    }
    Answer {
        string id PK "cuid"
        string submissionId FK
        string questionId FK
        string text "optional: text, JSON list, or file id"
        float number "optional: number answers only"
    }
```

Firestore layout (`firestore.mmd`)

```
flowchart TB
    subgraph FS["Cloud Firestore (default) database"]
        direction TB
        F["forms / {formId}<br/>title, description, createdAt,<br/>questions[ ] embedded,<br/>
    responseCount"]
        S["forms / {formId} / submissions / {submissionId}<br/>createdAt, answers { questionId:
    value }"]
        FI["files / {fileId}<br/>name, type,<br/>data (base64, max 700 KB)"]
    end
    F -- "subcollection" --> S
    S -. "file answer holds the fileId" .-> FI
    PG[("PostgreSQL<br/>source of truth")]
    PG -- "same ids, one-way mirror" --> F
    PG -- "same ids, one-way mirror" --> S
```

Architecture (architecture.mmd)

```
flowchart LR
    subgraph Browser["Browser (Next.js client)"]
        direction TB
        RHF["react-hook-form<br/>+ zodResolver"]
        BF["better-fetch<br/>lib/fetch.ts"]
        UP["FileUploadField<br/>plain fetch + FormData"]
        RHF --> BF
    end

    SH{{"Shared Zod schemas<br/>lib/schemas/*.ts"}}

    subgraph Next["Next.js server (one deployment)"]
        direction TB
        RH["app/api/[[...route]]/route.ts<br/>hono/vercel handle()"]
        subgraph Hono["Hono app (lib/server/app.ts)"]
            direction TB
            ZV{{"validate()<br/>json / param / query"}}
            R1["routes/forms.ts"]
            R2["routes/submissions.ts"]
            R3["routes/files.ts"]
            R4["routes/sync.ts<br/>Bearer SYNC_TOKEN"]
            M405["methodNotAllowed()<br/>405 + Allow"]
        end
        subgraph Repo["Repository layer (lib/server/repo)"]
            direction TB
            FAC["forms.ts / submissions.ts<br/>facade"]
            DUAL["dual.ts<br/>mirrorSafely, readWithFallback"]
            PGR["postgres/*<br/>Prisma"]
            FSR["firestore/*<br/>Admin SDK"]
            FIL["files.ts"]
            SYN["sync.ts"]
        end
        RH --> ZV
        ZV --> R1
        ZV --> R2
        ZV --> R3
        ZV --> R4
        R1 -.-> M405
        R2 -.-> M405
        R3 -.-> M405
        R1 --> FAC
        R2 --> FAC
        R2 --> FIL
        R3 --> FIL
        R4 --> SYN
        FAC --> DUAL
        DUAL --> PGR
        DUAL --> FSR
        SYN --> PGR
        SYN --> FSR
    end

    PG[("PostgreSQL<br/>Form, Question,<br/>Submission, Answer<br/>(source of truth)")]
    FS[("Cloud Firestore<br/>forms, submissions,<br/>files (mirror)")]

    BF -- "HTTP JSON" --> RH
    UP -- "multipart POST /api/files" --> RH
    PGR --> PG
    FSR --> FS
    FIL --> FS

    SH -. "imported by" .-> RHF
```

```
    SH -. "imported by" .-> BF
    SH -. "imported by" .-> ZV
```

Architecture with planned extensions (architecture_planned.mmd)

```
flowchart LR
    subgraph Browser["Browser (Next.js client)"]
        direction TB
        RHF["react-hook-form<br/>+ zodResolver"]
        BF["better-fetch<br/>lib/fetch.ts"]
        UP["FileUploadField<br/>plain fetch + FormData"]
        DEL["DeleteFormButton<br/>(planned)"]
        EDT["Edit page + FormBuilder<br/>edit mode (planned)"]
        RHF --> BF
        DEL --> BF
        EDT --> BF
    end

    SH{{"Shared Zod schemas<br/>lib/schemas/*.ts<br/>+ updateFormSchema (planned)"}}

    subgraph Next["Next.js server (one deployment)"]
        direction TB
        RH["app/api/[[...route]]/route.ts<br/>hono/vercel handle()"]
        subgraph Hono["Hono app (lib/server/app.ts)"]
            direction TB
            RL["rateLimit middleware<br/>429 + Retry-After (planned)"]
            AUTH["auth middleware<br/>owner check (planned, separate work)"]
            ZV{{"validate()<br/>json / param / query"}}
            R1["routes/forms.ts<br/>GET, POST, PUT (planned), DELETE"]
            R2["routes/submissions.ts"]
            R3["routes/files.ts"]
            R4["routes/sync.ts<br/>status, full sync,<br/>retry (planned)"]
        end
        subgraph Repo["Repository layer (lib/server/repo)"]
            direction TB
            FAC["forms.ts / submissions.ts<br/>facade"]
            DUAL["dual.ts<br/>mirrorSafely, readWithFallback"]
            PGR["postgres/*<br/>Prisma"]
            FSR["firestore/*<br/>Admin SDK"]
            FIL["files.ts<br/>chunked (planned)"]
            OUT["outbox.ts<br/>recordFailure, processTasks (planned)"]
            SYN["sync.ts"]
        end
        RH --> RL
        RL --> AUTH
        AUTH --> ZV
        ZV --> R1
        ZV --> R2
        ZV --> R3
        ZV --> R4
        R1 --> FAC
        R2 --> FAC
        R2 --> FIL
        R3 --> FIL
        R4 --> SYN
        R4 --> OUT
        FAC --> DUAL
        DUAL --> PGR
        DUAL --> FSR
        DUAL -- "mirror failed" --> OUT
        OUT --> PGR
        OUT --> FSR
```

```
        SYN --> PGR
        SYN --> FSR
    end

    LS[("Rate-limit store<br/>memory, then Redis (planned)")]
    PG[("PostgreSQL<br/>Form, Question, Submission, Answer<br/>+ MirrorTask (planned)")]
    FS[("Cloud Firestore<br/>forms, submissions, files (mirror)")]
    SCH["External scheduler<br/>cron / GitHub Actions (planned)"]

    BF -- "HTTP JSON" --> RH
    UP -- "multipart POST /api/files" --> RH
    SCH -- "Bearer SYNC_TOKEN" --> RH
    RL --> LS
    PGR --> PG
    OUT --> PG
    FSR --> FS
    FIL --> FS

    SH -. "imported by" .-> RHF
    SH -. "imported by" .-> BF
    SH -. "imported by" .-> ZV

    classDef planned stroke-dasharray: 5 4,stroke:#b45309,fill:#fffbeb,color:#78350f;
    class DEL,EDT,RL,AUTH,OUT,LS,SCH planned;
```

Development workflow (`development.mmd`)

```
flowchart TB
    subgraph Setup["1. Set up (once)"]
        direction LR
        S1["create-next-app<br/>--no-src-dir, Tailwind v4"]
        S2["npm install<br/>packages pinned"]
        S3[".env + .env.example<br/>Postgres URL, Firebase key,<br/>SYNC_TOKEN"]
        S4["prisma migrate dev<br/>prisma generate"]
        S1 --> S2 --> S3 --> S4
    end

    subgraph Build["2. Build in layers"]
        direction LR
        B1["lib/schemas<br/>one file per concern"]
        B2["lib/server<br/>env, db, firestore,<br/>errors, methods, validate"]
        B3["lib/server/repo<br/>postgres, firestore,<br/>dual, facade, files, sync"]
        B4["lib/server/routes + app.ts<br/>+ app/api route"]
        B5["lib/fetch.ts + patterns<br/>+ components + pages"]
        B1 --> B2 --> B3 --> B4 --> B5
    end

    subgraph Check["3. Check after every layer"]
        direction LR
        C1["prettier --check"]
        C2["tsc --noEmit"]
        C3["eslint ."]
        C4["npm run build"]
        C5["curl API checks<br/>405, 404, 400, 201<br/>(a failure sends you back<br/>to the layer that caused it)"]
        C1 --> C2 --> C3 --> C4 --> C5
    end

    subgraph Run["4. Run and try it"]
        direction LR
        R1["npm run dev"]
        R2["create form, open link,<br/>submit, read responses"]
```

```
        R3["sync status<br/>both databases equal"]
        R1 --> R2 --> R3
    end

    Setup --> Build
    Build --> Check
    Check -- "all pass" --> Run
```

Extension roadmap (`roadmap.mmd`)

```
flowchart TB
    DONE["Built: core app<br/>forms, validation, submissions,<br/>files, Postgres + Firestore
    mirror,<br/>405 / 404 / 500 handling"]
    E1["1. Login and form ownership"]
    E2["2. Rate limiting"]
    E3["3. Delete button<br/>+ delete a form's files"]
    E4["4. Sync outbox<br/>+ scheduled call"]
    E5["5. Form editing"]
    E6["6. File limits<br/>chunks or bucket"]
    END["Production-ready basic app"]

    DONE --> E1
    DONE --> E2
    E1 --> E3
    E2 --> E3
    E3 --> E4
    E3 --> E6
    E4 --> E5
    E5 --> END
    E6 --> END

    classDef built fill:#ecfdf5,stroke:#047857,color:#064e3b;
    classDef planned stroke-dasharray: 5 4,stroke:#b45309,fill:#fffbeb,color:#78350f;
    class DONE built;
    class E1,E2,E3,E4,E5,E6 planned;
```

Submission sequence (`sequence_write.mmd`)

```
sequenceDiagram
    autonumber
    actor U as Respondent
    participant P as Survey page
    participant A as Hono API
    participant PG as PostgreSQL
    participant FS as Firestore

    opt File question
        P->>A: POST /api/files (multipart file)
        A->>A: re-check type and size (max 700 KB)
        A->>FS: files/{fileId} = name, type, base64
        A-->>P: 201 { id }
    end

    U->>P: Submit answers
    P->>P: zodResolver validates (client)
    P->>A: POST /api/forms/:id/submissions
    A->>PG: load form + questions
    A->>A: buildAnswerSchema(questions) validates body
    alt Invalid
        A-->>P: 400 invalid_answers + issues
```

```
    else Unknown file id
        A->>FS: file exists?
        A-->>P: 400 Unknown file
    else Valid
        A->>PG: nested create: Submission + Answers (one transaction)
        PG-->>A: saved row
        A->>FS: transaction: set submission, responseCount +1 only if new
        Note over A,FS: a Firestore failure is logged, not returned
        A-->>P: 201 { id }
    end
```

Read fallback and sync sequence (`sequence_read.mmd`)

```
sequenceDiagram
    autonumber
    participant P as Page
    participant A as Hono API
    participant R as readWithFallback
    participant PG as PostgreSQL
    participant FS as Firestore
    participant O as Operator

    P->>A: GET /api/forms/:id
    A->>R: getForm(id)
    R->>PG: primary read
    alt Postgres answers (a row or null)
        PG-->>R: form or null
        R-->>A: result (null becomes 404)
    else Postgres throws (unreachable)
        PG--xR: error (logged)
        R->>FS: fallback read forms/{id}
        FS-->>R: form or null
        R-->>A: result
    end
    A-->>P: 200 form, or 404

    Note over O,FS: Repair after an outage or a restore
    O->>A: GET /api/sync/status (Bearer token)
    A->>PG: form ids and submission count
    A->>FS: form ids and submission counts
    A-->>O: missingInFirestore, onlyInFirestore, inSync
    O->>A: POST /api/sync (Bearer token)
    A->>PG: read all forms and submissions
    A->>FS: replace documents, set real counters
    A->>FS: delete forms that no longer exist in Postgres
    A-->>O: forms, submissions, removed
```